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ANSWERS & EXPLANATIONS

GENERAL STUDIES (P) TEST – 3798 (2023)

Q 1.D

- The contrast between the Nehru report of 1928 and the declared goal of the National Congress led to a raging controversy on the respective merits of “Dominion status” and “complete independence,” which became a first-class debating issue for the nationalist Press and for political meetings.
- Those who disagreed with the moderation of the All-Parties Conference came out with the proposal to **establish an Independence for India League to press for their point of view in the country at large**. They proclaimed that they were supporting the All-Parties’ Report for the sake of unity **without giving up their adherence to the Congress's goal of independence** in support of which they proposed to form a special organization.
- Independence for India League as an all-India body was thus formed for the first time in November 1928, with **Mr. Srinivasa Iyengar as President and S.C. Bose and Jawaharlal Nehru as joint secretaries**, has the support of many prominent Congress workers, but has no mass membership at all. **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 2.B

- Annie Besant was a prominent Theosophist, social reformer, political leader, women's rights activist, writer and orator. She was of Irish origin and made India her second home. She fought for the rights of Indians and was the first woman president of the Indian National Congress.
- **Annie Besant's famous literary works include**
 - **India: A Nation; A Plea for Self Government** book was written by Annie Besant in 1915. Annie Besant was known to be an untiring public worker as the head of various important movements and a protagonist in the struggle for the extension of women's rights.
 - In this book, she brought to the British eyes the actual Indian conditions and problems from the Indian point of view, and elucidated the true interests of India.
 - It sought to reconcile the Indian interests with the larger interests of the Empire by studying the political structure and with intimate and personal knowledge of Indian conditions and feelings.
 - The Ancient Wisdom
 - **My path to atheism**
 - The Future Of Indian Politics
 - A World Without God
 - Gandhian Non - Co-operation; Or, Shall India Commit Suicide?
 - Wake Up, India: A Plea For Social Reform
 - A Study in Karma
- As a **member and later president of the Theosophical Society**, Besant helped to spread Theosophical beliefs around the world, notably in India. Besant first visited India in 1893 and later settled there, becoming involved in the Indian nationalist movement.
- In 1916 **she established the Indian Home Rule League**, of which she became president. She was also a leading member of the Indian National Congress. Her long-time interest in education resulted in the **founding of the Central Hindu College at Benares (1898)**.
- **Annie Besant founded two newspapers, "The Commonweal" and "New India."**
- **Philosophy of Hinduism is one of the several unpublished writings of Dr. B.R Ambedkar.**
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 3.B

- **Once the way was cleared by Gandhi's ritual at Dandi, defiance of the salt laws started all over the country. Gandhi's arrest came on May 4, 1930, when he announced that he would lead a raid on Dharasana Salt Works on the west coast.**
- Gandhi's arrest was followed by massive protests in Bombay, Delhi, Calcutta, and in Sholapur, where the response was the most fierce. After Gandhi's arrest, the CWC sanctioned:
 - non-payment of revenue in ryotwari areas
 - no-chowkidara-tax campaign in zamindari areas
 - violation of forest laws in the Central Provinces
- **On May 21, 1930, Sarojini Naidu, Imam Sahib (Gandhi's South Africa days colleague), and Manilal (Gandhi's son) took up the unfinished task of leading a raid on the Dharasana Salt Works with the help of around 2500 marchers.**
 - The unarmed and peaceful crowd was met with a brutal lathi-charge which left 2 dead and 320 injured. This new form of salt satyagraha was eagerly adopted by people in Wadala (Bombay), Karnataka (Sanikatta Salt Works), Andhra, Midnapore, Balasore, Puri, and Cuttack.
- In landlocked Bihar, the manufacture of salt on a large scale was not practicable, and at most places, it was a mere gesture. **In Patna, Nakhas Pond was chosen as a site to make salt and break the salt law under Ambika Kant Sinha.** However, very soon, a very powerful no-chaukidari tax agitation replaced the salt satyagraha (owing to physical constraints in making salt).
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 4.A

- **Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms and Government of India Act, 1919:**
 - The British government, not prepared to part with or even share its power with the Indians, once again resorted to the policy of 'carrot and stick. The carrot was represented by the insubstantial Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms, while measures such as the Rowlatt Act represented the stick.
 - In line with the government policy contained in Montagu's statement of August 1917, the government announced further constitutional reforms in July 1918, known as Montagu-Chelmsford or Montford Reforms. Based on these, the Government of India Act, of 1919 was enacted.
 - **Main Features: The main features of the Montford Reforms were as follows.**
 - **Provincial Government**—Introduction of Dyarchy: The Act introduced dyarchy for the executive at the provincial government level.
 - **Executive:** Dyarchy, i.e., the rule of two—executive councilors and famous ministers—was introduced. The governor was to be the executive head of the province. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - **Subjects were divided into two lists:** 'reserved' which included subjects such as law and order, finance, land revenue, irrigation, etc., and 'transferred' subjects such as education, health, local government, industry, agriculture, excise, etc. **The reserved subjects were to be administered by the governor through his executive council of bureaucrats,** and the transferred subjects were to be administered by ministers nominated from among the elected members of the legislative council. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - The ministers were to be responsible to the legislature and had to resign if a no-confidence motion was passed against them by the legislature, while the executive councilors were not to be responsible to the legislature.
 - In case of failure of constitutional machinery in the province, the governor could take over the administration of transferred subjects also.
 - The secretary of state for India and the governor-general could interfere in respect of reserved subjects while in respect of transferred matters, the scope for their interference was restricted.
 - **Legislature:**
 - Provincial legislative councils were further expanded and 70 percent of the members were to be elected. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**
 - The system of communal and class electorates was further consolidated.
 - Women were also given the right to vote.

- The legislative councils could initiate legislation but the governor's assent was required. The governor could veto bills and issue ordinances.
- The legislative councils could reject the budget but the governor could restore it, if necessary.
- The legislators enjoyed the freedom of speech.

Q 5.A

- At the start of World War II, Bose was placed under house arrest by the British Raj. He escaped in disguise and made his way through Afghanistan and Central -Asia. He came first to the Soviet Union and then to Germany, reaching Berlin on 2 April 1941.
- There, Bose met Hitler under the pseudo name, Orlando Mazzotta. **With the help of Hitler, He formed the 'Freedom Army' (Mukti Sena) also known as Free Indian Legion which consisted of all the prisoners of war of Indian origin captured by Germany and Italy. Hence, statements 1 is correct and and statement 2 is not correct.**
- Dresden, Germany was made the office of the Freedom Army. Bose came to be called 'Netaji' by the people of Germany. He gave the famous slogan, 'Jai Hind' from the Free India Centre, Germany.
- He began regular broadcasts from Berlin radio in January **1942 called Azad Hind Radio, which enthused Indians. Azad Hind Radio was a radio service** that was started under the leadership of Subhas Chandra Bose and Adolf Hitler in Nazi Germany in 1942 **to encourage Indians to fight for the Axis powers.** Though initially based in Nazi Germany, its headquarters were shifted to Japanese occupied Singapore, and later to Hyderabad, following the course of the war in Southeast Asia.
- **After Netaji's departure to Southeast Asia, the German operations were continued by A.C.N. Nambiar, the head of the Indian Legion in Nazi Germany** and later ambassador of the Arzi Hukumat Azad Hind in Germany.
- In early 1943, he left Germany and travelled by German and later by Japanese submarines to **reach Japan and then Singapore in July, 1943.**
- He was to **take over command of the Indian independence movement from Rashbehari Bose, but that was the second phase of the Indian National Army.**

Q 6.C

- **Commonwealth Games:**
 - The Commonwealth Games, more often than not known as the Friendly Games, are an international multisport competition held every four years for athletes belonging to the Commonwealth of Nations. Since its debut in 1930, the games have been conducted every four years with the exception of 1942 and 1946 (both of which were postponed owing to World War II).
 - From 1930 to 1950, the events were known as the British Empire Games, from 1954 to 1966 as the British Empire and Commonwealth Games, and from 1970 to 1974 as the British Commonwealth Games. Since 2002, athletes with disabilities have been accepted as full members of their country teams, making the Commonwealth Games the first international multisport competition to be completely inclusive.
 - The Games are overseen by the Commonwealth Games Federation (CGF), which controls the sporting program and selects host cities. Although there are 56 members of the Commonwealth of Nations, there are 72 Commonwealth Games Associations. They are divided into 6 regions (Africa, Americas, Caribbean, Europe, Asia, and Oceania) and each of them has a similar function to the National Olympic Committees in relation to their countries or territories. **Countries outside the Commonwealth are not invited and therefore do not take part. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - **Commonwealth Games 2022:** The most recent Commonwealth Games, the 22nd, were held in Birmingham from 28 July to 8 August 2022. The next Commonwealth Games will be the first games in history held in a decentralized way, as they are scheduled to be hosted across four cities in the Australian state of Victoria from 17 to 29 March 2026.
 - **Five new and returning sports** will be featured at this year's Commonwealth Games in Birmingham. **Women's T20 Cricket will return after a 24-year absence, with 3x3 basketball to feature prominently and para Table Tennis to participate** in table tennis for the first time. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 7.A

- **Communist Party of India**
 - **On December 26, 1925**, a few ardent young patriots moved by the urge to free the motherland from colonial bondage, inspired by the Great October Socialist Revolution and fired with revolutionary zeal, braved imperialist persecution and **came together in the city of Kanpur, to form the Communist Party of India** with a view to fight for national independence and a future of socialism.
 - The birth of the CPI was the result of tremendous historical developments at home and abroad.
 - It was the representatives of all these anti-imperialist currents, who came together to found the CPI in Kanpur at the foundation meeting (26-28 December 1925), and who thereafter flocked into its ranks.
 - The **AITUC which had been set up in 1920** grew into the premier and united mass organization of the Indian working class – a position that it held till 1947, despite occasional divergences and splits which were however soon overcome.
 - **In 1936** along with many revolutionary-democratic personalities the **All India Kisan Sabha** was set up, under whose banner in the years to come, mighty anti-feudal peasant actions demanding an end to the zamindari system, security of tenancy rights, and land to those who till it, were fought.
 - The same year, i.e. **in 1936 the All India Student's Federation was founded**, which emerged as the foremost champion and leader of the student movement throughout the country. Several generations of its leading cadres joined the CPI.
 - 1936 too saw the founding of the **Progressive Writers' Association** in which communist writers played a prominent part. Another big step forward was taken in 1943, with the formation of the **Indian Peoples' Theatre Association (IPTA)**. It was a landmark in the development of our great national culture. Revolutionary songs, plays, ballets, street plays, and revival of folk forms of art and culture, have helped to bring the people to culture and culture to the people. **Hence options 1 and 2 are correct.**
 - **NOTE:** The **Indian Association** was the first avowed nationalist organization **founded in British India by Surendranath Banerjee and Ananda Mohan Bose** in 1876. The objectives of this Association were "promoting by every legitimate means the political, intellectual and material advancement of the people". **Hence option 3 is not correct.**

Q 8.C

- **Mahatma Gandhi, in 1898**, went to South Africa in connection with a case involving his client, Dada Abdullah. He witnessed the ugly face of white racism and the humiliation and contempt to which Asians were subjected. He stayed there till 1914 after which he returned to India.
- During the early moderate phase, Gandhiji relied on sending petitions to authorities. In this phase, Gandhiji decided that the **Indian Opinion (1903)**, his weekly paper, should be printed at a farm away from the city, he purchased an estate in **Natal province**, fourteen miles from Durban (South Africa). This would be a place where everyone would labor, and draw the same salary. **He called this the Phoenix Settlement.** Also, **Gandhiji began Indian Opinion as a means to serve and consolidate the Indian community.** The succession of meetings and events which culminated in the founding of the Phoenix Settlement began when Madanjit Vyavaharik (co-owner of Indian Opinion, with Gandhi) learnt of an outbreak of plague in the vicinity of Johannesburg while canvassing subscribers and collecting subscriptions. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- In 1907 when the Transvaal legislature passed a law requiring all Asians to take out registration cards, he launched a campaign of passive resistance, coining the phrase, satyagraha.
- He also set up the **Tolstoy Farm (1910)** for all those taking part in the movement. He also campaigned against restrictions on Indian migration and against poll tax.
- The Indians protested the **Transvaal Immigration Act, by illegally migrating from Natal into Transvaal.** Gokhale toured the whole country (India) mobilizing public opinion in support of the Indians in South Africa. Even Lord Hardinge, condemned the repression by the British.
- Eventually, through a series of negotiations involving Gandhi, Lord Hardinge, C.F. Andrews, and General Smuts, an agreement (**Gandhi-Smuts Agreement**) was reached in **June 1914** by which the Government of South Africa conceded the major Indian demands relating to the poll tax, the registration certificates and marriages solemnized according to Indian rites, and promised to treat the issue of Indian immigration in a sympathetic manner. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
- The **Natal Indian Ambulance Corps** was created by **Mahatma Gandhi** for use by the British as stretcher-bearers during the **Second Boer War**, with expenses met by the local Indian community. Gandhi was

bestowed with the '**Kaiser-i-Hind**' and other medals by the British for his work in the Boer war. This was **given up** by Gandhi after the **Jallianwala Bagh massacre**. Hence statement 2 is correct.

Q 9.A

- The Secretary of State for India called for restrictions on immigration to Canada and USA.
- The combined pressure resulted in an effective restriction on Indian immigration into Canada in 1908. **Tarak Nath Das, an Indian student, and one of the first leaders of the Indian community in North America to start a paper (called Free Hindustan)** realized that while the British government was keen on Indians going to Fiji to work as laborers for British planters, it did not want them to go to North America where they might be infected by ideas of liberty.
- **The discriminatory policies of the host countries soon resulted in a flurry of political activity among Indian nationalists. Tarak Nath Das in Vancouver started the Free Hindustan and adopted a very militant nationalist tone; Guru Dutt Kumar set up a Swadesh Sevak Home in Vancouver on the lines of the India House in London and also began to bring out a Gurmukhi paper called Swadesh Sevak which advocated social reform and also asked Indian troops to rise in revolt against the British.**
 - In 1910, Tarak Nath Das and G.D. Kumar, by now forced out of Vancouver, set up the **United India House in Seattle in the US, where every Saturday they lectured to a group of twenty-five Indian laborers.**
 - Close links also developed between the United India House group, consisting mainly of radical nationalist students, and the Khalsa Diwan Society, and in 1913 they decided to send a deputation to meet the Colonial Secretary in London and the Viceroy and other officials in India
 - The result of this sustained agitation, both in Canada and the United States, was the creation of a nationalist consciousness and feeling of solidarity among immigrant Indians.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- Sohan Singh Bhakna was the founder and president of the Ghadar Party.
- **Bhai Parmanand** was a close associate of Lala Hardayal and assisted him in organizing the activities of the Ghadr Party in the US. He returned to India in 1913 and was arrested in the Lahore Conspiracy case.
 - His death sentence was commuted to life imprisonment by Lord Hardinge. After his release in 1920, he became the Chancellor of National College, Lahore.
 - A staunch Arya Samajist, Bhai Parmanand resented certain policies of the Congress that he felt were pro-Muslim. He joined the Hindu Mahasabha and in 1933 was elected as its President.

Q 10.A

- **Shimla Conference, 1945** was a conference of 21 Indian political leaders invited to Shimla, the summer capital of the British Government, **to discuss the provisions of the Wavell Plan.**
- **Proposals of The Wavell Plan 1945 were:**
 - **With the exception of the governor-general and the commander-in-chief, all members of the executive council were to be Indians.**
 - At that council, **Hindus and Muslims of the high class would have equal representation.**
 - In addition to low-caste Hindus, Sikhs and other minorities would also be represented on the Council.
 - Among the members of the Council for Foreign Affairs would be an Indian.
 - An English commissioner, however, would be appointed to deal with the trade-related matters.
 - **Up until the transfer of power to India, the defence of India was to be undertaken by a British authority.**
 - **By selecting 6 representatives, the Muslims, who made up only about 25% of the total population, were given the opportunity to over represent themselves in the proposed Executive Council.**
- **Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, the President of the Congress at the time, was among the leaders. Mohammad Ali Jinnah and Mahatma Gandhi was also present at the conference.** It was convened to agree on and approve the Wavell Plan for Indian self-government. However, talks came to a halt over the issue of selecting Muslim representatives. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Jinnah stated that no non-league Muslim should be represented on the Executive Council because only the Muslim League has the authority to represent Indian Muslims. Jinnah also demanded that if votes were divided and Muslim members objected, a provision be added requiring a two-thirds majority to clear a vote.**

- Wavell had appointed **six Muslims to the Executive Council of 14**, and the British had given it the power to Veto any constitutional proposal that was not in its best interests. However, **Muslims made up only 25% of the Indian population**. As a result, Congress rejected these unreasonable demands.
- **Lord Wavell could not agree to Jinnah's point of view as well that Muslim League is the sole representative of Indian Muslims. Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- Lord Wavell concluded the Conference by declaring the talks a failure.

Q 11.C

- **Why in news?** Recently, the Union Home Minister inaugurated the National Automated Fingerprint Identification System (NAFIS) at the National Security Strategies Conference.
 - **More about the National Automated Fingerprint Identification System (NAFIS)**
 - The National Automated Fingerprints Identification System (NAFIS) project is a country-wide, centralized, and searchable database of crime- and criminal-related fingerprints.
 - It is conceptualized and managed by the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) at the Central Fingerprint Bureau (CFPB) in New Delhi. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - Recently, Madhya Pradesh became the first state in the country to identify a deceased person through NAFIS.
 -
 - **Web-based application:** The web-based application functions as a central information repository by consolidating fingerprint data from all states and Union Territories.
 - **Unique ID:** NAFIS assigns a **unique 10-digit National Fingerprint Number (NFN) to each person arrested for a crime**. This unique ID will be used for the person's lifetime, and different crimes registered under different FIRs will be linked to the same NFN. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Q 12.D

- **Nagpur session of the Indian National Congress, December 1920 :**
 - **C.R. Das moved the main resolution** on Non-Cooperation in the annual session of Congress in Nagpur in 1920. In the Nagpur session, Congress decided to the attainment of Swaraj through peaceful and legitimate means, thus committing itself to an extra-constitutional mass struggle. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - The program of non-cooperation was endorsed.
 - An important change was made in the Congress creed: now, **instead of having the attainment of self-government through constitutional means as its goal, Congress decided to have the attainment of swaraj through peaceful and legitimate means, thus committing itself to an extra-constitutional mass struggle. Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
 - Some important organizational changes were made: a congress working committee (CWC) of 15 members was set up to lead the Congress from now onwards; **provincial congress committees on a linguistic basis were organized; Hence statement 3 is correct.**
 - Ward committees were organized, and the entry fee was reduced to four annas.

Q 13.B

- **Ishara was a pamphlet/book written by Jyotiba Phule in 1885.** It contained Phule's main ideas on economics of the agrarian classes. Aware of the problems of agricultural labourers and small peasant cultivators, Phule supported them in their struggles. **Hence pair 1 is not correctly matched.**
 - Other works by phule include Trutiya Ratna, Ballad: Chhatrapati Shivajiraje Bhonsale Yancha Powada, Gulamgiri, Sarvajaneek Satyadharma Pustak, Satsaar, Shetkaryacha Asood etc.
 - In 1873, Jyotiba Phule formed the Satya Shodhak Samaj (Society of Seekers of Truth). He undertook a systematic deconstruction of existing beliefs and history, only to reconstruct an equality-promoting version.
- **Kudi Arasu was a newspaper started by E.V. Ramasami Naicker in 1925.**
 - **E.V. Ramasami Naicker, popularly known as Periyar became a hero of Satyagraha at Vaikom, Kerala, when he vehemently supported the 'Harijans'.** With the starting of his paper, Kudi Arasu, in 1925, he turned into a radical social reformer. In fact, Periyar resigned as Secretary of the Madras Provincial Congress Committee over an incident in which Brahmin and non-Brahmin eating facilities

were segregated in a gurukul (school) run by congress. He left the Congress in 1925. **Hence pair 2 is correctly matched.**

- **Mahatma Gandhi began publishing Harijan, a weekly newspaper, in English in 1933. It lasted until 1948.** During this time, he also published Harijan Bandu in Gujarati, and Harijan Sevak in Hindi. **Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**
- **Who Were the Shudras? is a history book published by Indian social reformer and polymath B. R. Ambedkar in 1946.** The book discusses **the origin of the Shudra Varna.** **Ambedkar dedicated the book to Jyotirao Phule. Hence pair 4 is not correctly matched.**
 - His other important works were: **The Annihilation of Caste** and **The Untouchables Who Were They And Why They Became Untouchables?**

Q 14.B

- **The Dominion of India** was an independent dominion in the British Commonwealth of Nations **existing between 15 August 1947 and 26 January 1950. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The Dominion of India was **formalised by the passage of the Indian Independence Act 1947**, which also formalised an independent Dominion of Pakistan—comprising the regions of British India that are today Pakistan and Bangladesh.
- **Recommendations of the Nehru report, 1928 were:**
 - **Dominion status for India (like Canada, Australia, etc.) within the British Commonwealth.** (This point was a bone of contention with the younger set of leaders including Jawaharlal Nehru and Subhas Chandra Bose who favoured complete independence.) **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - Nineteen fundamental rights including the right to vote for men and women above 21 years of age, unless disqualified.
 - Equal rights for men and women as citizens.
 - No state religion.
 - No separate electorates for any community. It did provide for the reservation of minority seats.
 - A federal form of government with residual powers with the centre. There would be a bicameral legislature at the centre. The ministry would be responsible to the legislature.
- The **Cripps Mission** was sent by the British government to India in March 1942 to obtain Indian cooperation for the British war efforts in the 2nd World War. For the first time, the British government **acknowledged India's right to be dominion and framing their own Constitution. Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**
- **Proposals of Cripps Mission were:**
 - **Setting up of an Indian dominion.** This dominion would have the freedom to remain with the British Commonwealth or to secede from it.
 - A Constituent Assembly would be formed to frame a new constitution for the country.
 - Any province unwilling to join the Indian dominion could form a separate union and have a separate constitution.
 - The transfer of power and the rights of minorities would be safeguarded by negotiations between the Constituent Assembly and the British government.

Q 15.B

- Recently, Parliament **passed the Indian Antarctic Bill, 2022.**
- It is the **first domestic legislation** with regard to Antarctica in India. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The Bill seeks to give effect to the **Antarctic Treaty, the Convention on the Conservation of Antarctic Marine Living Resources, and the Protocol on Environmental Protection to the Antarctic Treaty.**
- **Key Features:**
 - Prohibit Indian expedition to Antarctica **without permit or written authorisation** of another party to Antarctic Treaty. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
 - **Extend jurisdiction of Indian courts to Antarctica** and lays out penal provision for crimes on the continent by Indian citizens, foreign citizens who are part of Indian expeditions. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

- The act directs creating a **fund called the Antarctic fund** that will be used for protecting the Antarctic environment.
- The Bill also establishes a '**Committee on Antarctic Governance and Environmental Protection.**'
- **Prohibits mining, dredging and activities** that threaten the pristine conditions of the continent.
- Antarctica Treaty:
 - The Treaty covers the area **south of 60°S latitude.**
 - It's objective is to demilitarize Antarctica; use for peaceful purposes & resolve disputes.
 - **Signed in 1959 by 12 countries:** Argentina, Australia, Belgium, Chile, France, Japan, New Zealand, Norway, South Africa, USSR, the UK and the USA, and came into force in 1961.
 - **India signed the Antarctic Treaty** in 1983.
 - **Convention on the Conservation of Antarctic Marine Living Resources (CCAMLR):** Set up in 1980 for the protection and preservation of the Antarctic.
 - **Madrid Protocol:** Designates Antarctica as a "natural reserve, devoted to peace and science" (**Signed by India**).

Q 16.A

- **In the Barak Valley, political activity began during the swadeshi movement under the aegis of Kamini Kumar Chanda.**
- Kamini Kumar Chanda being an old co-worker of Surendranath Banerjee in the Students Association and a personal friend of Bipin Chandra Pal was an active link between the two and at times was successful in bringing the two giants of Indian national politics together.
- The trends which were visible in often parts of Bengal, such as constructive or positive Swadeshi, boycott, national education, labor unrest, the emergence of samitis, Hindu-Muslim unity; and a shift to terrorism were experienced in Barak Valley also.
- **The Cachar Swadeshi Sabha was established in 1905, with Chanda as the president and Abontinath Dutta as the secretary.** A massive campaign was carried out under the auspicious of Swadeshi Saba in favour of the anti-partition movement.
 - **The Cachar Swadeshi Sabha successfully spearheaded the agitation in the Barak Valley and preached the swadeshi ideals. Almost everyday protest meetings were organized and students made large-scale bonfires of British goods in this boycott movement.**
- **The Surma Valley Association was established on 1st August 1906.** The Surma Valley Association provided the political forum for the nationalist leaders of the Surma and Barak Valley in the early decades of the 20th century.
- In 1906, when the whole country was swept by the tides of swadeshi in the wake of the partition of Bengal, **the members of the Srihatta Swadesh Sebak Samiti under the Presidentship of Sarada Charan Shyam decided to organize a conference in the Surma Valley for spreading the ideals of swadeshi movement in both the districts of Barak Valley.**
 - Within an incredibly short time, the samitii drew the attention of Bipin Chandra Pal and Kamini Kumar Chanda. By the middle of 1906, the Srihatta Swadesh Sebak Samiti voluntarily liquidated itself to form the Surma Valley Political Conference. The first session of the Surma Valley Political Conference was held on 11th and 12th August 1906 in the house of Late Surya Kumar Das of Telehowr under the Presidentship of Chanda and was addressed by Pal.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- **Additional Information**
 - **Durga Mohan Das** was a Brahmo Samaj leader and a social reformer.
 - **Barindra Kumar Ghosh**, the younger brother of Sri Aurobindo Ghosh, was an Indian revolutionary and journalist. In the year 1906, Barindra Kumar published the Bengali weekly Jugantar. Later, the secret revolutionary arm Jugantar was formed under the guise of a fitness club in Bengal. He, along with Jatindranath Mukherjee (or Bagha Jatin), was instrumental in recruiting young revolutionaries
 - In the Alipore Bomb Case, Barindra Ghosh and Ullaskar Dutta (a member of the Jugantar party) were sentenced to death. With the intervention of Deshbandhu Chittaranjan Das, the sentence was reduced to life imprisonment. In 1909, Barindra Kumar was deported to the Cellular Jail, Andaman.

Q 17.B

- **In 1932, in the wake of the second Round Table Conference, two pacts were concluded in quick succession between leaders of caste Hindus and the Depressed Classes. While the Poona Pact, associated with Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, acquired a landmark status in modern Indian history, the earlier Rajah-Moonje Pact, espousing identical principles, has been all but eclipsed in**

popular memory. The accord was signed between **M.C. Rajah, President of the All India Depressed Classes Association, and B.S. Moonje of the Hindu Mahasabha.**

- **Announced in February 1932** amidst a raging controversy on the appropriate means of ensuring representation to the **Depressed Classes in the provincial legislatures, the Rajah-Moonje Pact was the first ever agreement on reservations and a joint electorate between caste Hindus and the Depressed Classes.**
 - In its outright rejection of separate electorates then advocated by the British and Dr. Ambedkar, it was a blow to divisive colonial politics and Ambedkar's assertions to Depressed Class leadership.
 - But, despite the stir it created, the Rajah- Moonje Pact was superseded six months later by the Poona Pact, which reiterated the agreement on reservations for the Depressed Classes with a joint electorate.
- **M.C. Rajah** was the Secretary of the Adi Dravida Mahajan Society in Madras province and had established himself as the leader of the Dalit classes by the time Dr. Ambedkar returned to India in 1917 after completing his studies in the United States.
 - He had been nominated as the first representative of the Dalits to join the Central Legislative Assembly in 1927 and continued to be a member until 1937. He was also made a minister in the provisional cabinet before the Rajagopalachari cabinet was formed in Madras province in 1937.
- **Dr. Balakrishna Shivaram Moonje** had started the Bhonsala Military School at Nasik. Dr. Moonje found special interest, was annihilating the caste difference in society, he figured out the prominent Brahmin participation in responsive society and encouraged the non-Brahmins to participate in elections.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 18.D

- Recently, the government notified Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022 to ensure environmentally sound management of waste batteries. **The new rules replace the Batteries (Management and Handling) Rules, 2001. The new rules cover the following types of batteries:**
 - Electric Vehicle batteries,
 - Portable batteries,
 - Automotive batteries and
 - Industrial batteries. **Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.**
- **Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR):** The rules function based on the concept of Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR). The producers (including importers) of batteries are responsible for the collection and recycling/refurbishment of waste batteries. They are also responsible for the use of recovered materials from waste into new batteries.
 - **Environmental compensation:** On the principle of Polluter Pays Principle, environmental compensation will be imposed for non-fulfillment of Extended Producer Responsibility targets, responsibilities and obligations set out in the rules.
 - **Funds under compensation:** The funds collected under environmental compensation shall be utilized in collecting, refurbishing, or recycling uncollected and non-recycled waste batteries.
- **Recycling:** EPR mandates that all waste batteries be collected and sent for recycling/refurbishment, and it prohibits disposal in landfills and incineration. Producers can engage themselves or authorize any other entity for the purpose. The rules promote the setting up of new industries and entrepreneurship in the collection and recycling/refurbishment of waste batteries.
- **Online portal:** The rules will enable the setting up of a mechanism and centralized online portal for the exchange of EPR certificates between producers and recyclers/refurbishers to fulfill the obligations of producers.

Q 19.A

- On 23 April, 1930, the arrest of Congress leaders in the North West Frontier Province led to a mass demonstration of unprecedented magnitude in Peshawar. Khan Abdul Gaffar Khan had been active for several years in the area, and it was his mass work which lay behind the formation of the band of non-

violent revolutionaries, the **Khudai Khidmatgars, popularly known as the Red Shirts** - who played an active role in the Civil Disobedience Movement.

- The atmosphere created by their political work contributed to the mass upsurge in Peshawar during which the city was virtually in the hands of the crowd for more than a week. **The Peshawar demonstrations are significant because it was here that the soldiers of the Garhwali regiments refused to fire on the unarmed crowd. Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- Chandra Singh Garhwali, the leader of this Garhwal rifle regiment refused to open fire on a group of unarmed people who were resisting the British rule using non-violent means, thereby preventing another massacre on the scale of Jallianwalla Bagh.

Q 20.D

- Recently, **India** has shown interest in joining the USA-led Minerals Security Partnership (MSP).
- Minerals Security Partnership (MSP) is a **US-led** partnership initiative that **aims to bolster critical mineral supply chains. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
 - The new grouping is aimed at **catalysing investment** from **governments** and the **private sector** to develop **strategic opportunities.**
- **The US and 10 partners** — Australia, Canada, Finland, France, Germany, Japan, the Republic of Korea (South Korea), Sweden, the United Kingdom, and the European Commission — have come together to form the MSP. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- The alliance is seen as primarily focused on evolving an alternative to China, which has created a **processing infrastructure in rare earth minerals** and has acquired mines in Africa for elements such as **Cobalt.**
- The partnership is also seen as a part of a **global ‘China-plus-one’ strategy** adopted post the Covid-19 pandemic that caused massive supply-chain disruptions.
 - **What is China Plus One?**
 - The strategy is also known simply as Plus One, is the **business strategy to avoid investing only in China and diversify** business into other countries.
 - For the **last 20 years**, western companies have invested in China, drawn in by their low production costs, and enormous domestic consumer markets.

Q 21.A

- **Communist Party of India (CPI)**
 - Many communists were imprisoned in the Kanpur Bolshevik Conspiracy Case in 1924, including S.A. Dange, Muzaffar Ahmed, Shaukat Usmani, and Nalini Gupta.
 - The CPI was formally **founded in 1925 at the Indian Communist Conference in Kanpur. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - The government crackdown on communists resulted in the arrest and trial of 31 leading communists, trade unionists, and left-wing leaders in 1929; they were tried in Meerut in the famous Meerut conspiracy case.
 - Workers' and peasants' parties sprouted up across the country, spreading Marxist and communist ideas.
 - All of these communist groups and workers' and peasants' parties remained a part of the national movement and collaborated with Congress.
 - The British government did not favor the activities of the Communists in India and **on 23rd July 1934, it imposed a ban on the functioning of the party. Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
 - In 1934 the party was accepted as the Indian section of the Communist International.
 - When Indian left-wing elements formed the Congress Socialist Party in 1934, the CPI branded it as Social Fascist.
 - The CPI had abandoned nonviolent modes of political action in favor of armed resistance to British imperialism under its new strategic direction.
 - In July 1942, the CPI was legalized, as a result of Britain and the Soviet Union becoming allies against Nazi Germany. Communists strengthened their control over the All India Trade Union Congress. At the same time, communists were politically cornered for **their opposition to the Quit India Movement.**

Q 22.D

- The first world war animated the revolutionaries with the hope that a great opportunity had come for throwing off the shackles of the country's subjugation. It created great revolutionary fervor. It was the belief of the revolutionaries that Great Britain disturbed by war would not be able to checkmate an armed uprising in India.
- **Rash Behari Bose** alone contemplated the 'All-India armed uprising'. In April 1914, **Virendranath Chattopadhyaya** shifted himself to Germany where he was carrying on revolutionary activities in close association with **Madam Cama, S.R. Rana (who were in Paris), and Jnanendra Dasgupta, Naren Sen, and Padmanabhan Pillai were in Switzerland.**
- The revolutionary leader's **Champak Raman Pillai and Chanji Kersump were already in Germany.** The first initiative for taking German assistance for Indian revolutionaries was taken by Virendranath Chattopadhyaya and Abinash Bhattacharya.
- They met Baron Oppenheim in Berlin in the first week of September 1914 and gave him a draft of the terms of mutual cooperation between the Indian revolutionaries and Germany. Oppenheim did a fine job and formed a society named Deutsche Verein der Freunde Indian (Indian Friendship Society of Germany).
 - Herr Albert Berlin (who was the then General Manager of Hamburg America Steamer Company) was its President. Baron Oppenheim and Dr. Sukhtankar were its Vice-Presidents and Dhiren Sarkar was its Secretary.
 - **The Society subsequently came to be known as the Indian Independence Committee and more popularly known as the Berlin Committee for Indian Independence. Virendranath Chattopadhyaya was its Secretary till the end of 1916 when Bhupendra Nath Duta succeeded him.**
- Virendranath Chattopadhyaya sent Dhiren Sarkar and S.S. Martha to America to establish contact with the Indian revolutionaries living in America: **Lala Har Dayal, Bhupendra Nath Dutta, Tarak Nath Das, Birendra Nath Dasgupta, etc.** All came to Berlin and joined the Berlin Committee for Indian Independence.
- Different plans were made by Berlin Committee for Indian Independence and the German Government for organizing an armed uprising in India during the first global war. There were three different schemes which are as follows:
 - The Afghan Scheme: was directed towards utilizing the Muslim tribal disaffection in the NorthWest Frontier and establishing a provisional government.
 - The Batavia Scheme: mainly relied on Bengal revolutionaries.
 - The Bangkok Scheme: relied on the coordinated activities of revolutionaries in India and the 'returned Sikhs' of the Ghadar Party.
- The Afghan Scheme was directed towards utilizing the Muslim tribal disaffection in the NorthWest Frontier and establishing a provisional government.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 23.C

- **Socialist Party, or (CSP),** was a left-wing group within Congress. It was formed with **Acharya Narendra Deva as President and Jay Prakash Narayan as General Secretary in 1934.** The CSP was not separate from the Congress. It worked within the Indian National Congress with a twin objectives of independence and socialism.
- The CSP advocated decentralised socialism in which co-operatives, trade unions, independent farmers, and local authorities would hold a substantial share of the economic power. As secularists, they hoped to transcend communal divisions through class solidarity. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- During the **World War II (1939-1945)** the CSP disagreed with the Congress offer of conditional help for British war efforts. They maintained that the war was a conflict between the partners of imperialism. **The Congress socialists wanted the Congress to wage a revolutionary mass struggle for independence.** They supported the Quit India Movement and took a leading part in organising the revolt. The CSP was not in favour of a negotiated settlement for the transfer of power but advocated the need for a revolutionary struggle to destroy edifices of imperialism, feudalism and communalism in India. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 24.A

- **Why in news?** A recent Report informs that the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) digital rupee — the Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) — may be introduced in phases beginning with wholesale businesses in the current financial year.
- **Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC):** CBDC is a **legal tender issued by a central bank in digital form. Hence statement 1 is correct.** It is the sovereign currency in an electronic form and it would appear as a liability (currency in circulation) on a central bank's balance sheet. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.** Though the concept of CBDCs was directly inspired by Bitcoin, it is different from decentralized virtual currencies and crypto assets, which are not issued by the state and lack legal tender status. The Reserve Bank of India will launch the CBDC in the upcoming financial year. This follows the government's plans to launch the CBDC which will be backed by blockchain technology.
- **Features:**
 - The underlying technology, form, and use of a CBDC can be molded for specific requirements.
 - It is similar to a fiat currency issued in paper and is interchangeable with any other fiat currency i.e., **CBDCs should be exchangeable at par with cash.**
 - The digital fiat currency or CBDC can be transacted using wallets backed by blockchain.
 - CBDCs enable the user to conduct both domestic and cross-border transactions which do not require a third party or a bank.

Q 25.C

- **The Congress Working Committee elected Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel as the President of the Karachi Congress** as the normal procedure for the election of President was not possible under the abnormal conditions that had prevailed for about a year. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The Karachi Congress session held in 1931 was a significant event Indian National Congress History. Before the Karachi Indian National Congress session, six days earlier Bhagat Singh, Rajguru and Sukhdev were executed on 23rd March 1931. This was an emotional upsurge following the execution of Bhagat Singh. While disapproving of and dissociating itself from political violence, the Congress admired the 'bravery' and 'sacrifice' of the three martyrs in the Karachi session.
- At the session, **Congress endorsed the Gandhi Irwin or Delhi Pact and reiterated the goal of Purna Swaraj. Hence statement 3 is correct.**
 - Two resolutions were adopted—one on Fundamental Rights and the other on National Economic Programme.
 - **The resolution on fundamental rights was drafted by Jawaharlal Nehru.** The resolution guaranteed the rights of free expression of opinion through speech and the Press and the freedom of association. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - This was the first time the Congress spelt out what swaraj would mean for the masses—"in order to end exploitation of masses, political freedom must include economic freedom of starving millions."

Q 26.B

- During his stay in South Africa, Gandhi Ji took various initiatives for the betterment of discriminated communities.
- One such discrimination was imposed by **new legislation in South Africa in 1906 which mandated migrant Indians to compulsorily carry at all times certificates of registration with their fingerprints.** The Indians under Gandhi's leadership decided not to submit to this discriminatory measure.
- **Gandhi formed the Passive Resistance Association to conduct the Satyagraha campaign.**
- As a response, the government jailed Gandhi Ji and others who refused to register themselves. Later, the authorities used deceit to make these defiant Indians register themselves. The Indians under the leadership of Gandhi retaliated by publicly burning their registration certificates.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 27.A

- **Gandhiji's struggle in South Africa:**
 - **Satyagraha against Registration Certificates (1906)**
 - The government in South Africa enacted legislation making it **compulsory for Indians to take out certificates of registration that held their fingerprints**. It was essential to carry these in person at all times. At a huge public meeting held on 11 September 1906, in the Empire Theatre in Johannesburg, Indians resolved that they would refuse to submit to this law and would face the consequences. The Government remained adamant, and so did the Indians. **Gandhiji formed the Passive Resistance Association in 1906 to conduct the campaign.**
 - General Smuts called Gandhiji for talks and promised to withdraw the legislation if Indians voluntarily agreed to register themselves. Gandhiji accepted and was the first to register. But Smuts ordered that the voluntary registrations be ratified under the law. The Indians under the leadership of Gandhiji retaliated by **publicly burning their registration certificates on 16, August 1908.**
 - **Campaign against Poll Tax and Invalidation of Indian Marriages**
 - **The movement was widened further to include resistance to the poll tax of three pounds that was imposed on all ex-indentured Indians.** The inclusion of the demand for the abolition of this tax, a particularly heavy charge on poor laborers whose wages hardly averaged ten shillings a month, immediately drew the indentured and ex-indentured laborers into the struggle.
 - **In March 1913, the satyagrahi's campaign was motivated again by government action. Supreme Court invalidated all marriages not conducted according to Christian rites and registered by the Registrar of Marriages.** By implication, Hindu, Muslim, and Parsi marriages were illegal and the children born through these marriages were illegitimate.

Q 28.A

- Syed Ameer Ali was born on 6th April 1849 at a Bengali village called Chansura. Ameer Ali founded a political organization in the year 1878 called National Mohammadan Association at Calcutta. It was later renamed as Central Mohammadan Association when lots of its branches started working all over India.
- **In 1907 he initiated the move of a political association of the Muslims in London, and on 6 May 1908, he formally inaugurated the London Branch of the All India Muslim League in a meeting at Caxton Hall. It was intended to advance and safeguard Muslim interests by constitutional and legal methods.**
- Ameer Ali and the London Muslim League had a momentous role in the realization of the Separate Muslim Electorate and in giving recognition to the political nationality of the Muslims of the subcontinent.
- In the draft scheme of Reforms, Lord Morley agreed to the principle of separate representation for the Muslims, but he did not provide for a separate Muslim electorate. He fixed the number of seats for each community to be filled by a Mixed Electoral College, composed of members of different communities in proportion to their numerical strength in each electoral area.
- **On 27 January 1909, Syed Ameer Ali led a strong deputation to Lord Morley and submitted a Memorial, pleading for a separate Muslim electorate. The effective agitation of Ameer Ali and the London Muslim League, influenced Lord Morley to provide for separate Muslim electorates in his Reforms Bill.**
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- **Additional Information**
- **Nawab Khwaja Salimullah** was the fourth Nawab of Dhaka and one of the leading Muslim politicians during British rule in India. He was one of the founders of the Muslim League.
- **A. K. Fazlul Huq** was a statesman, public leader, and holder of many high political posts including those of the Mayor of Calcutta (1935), and Chief Minister of undivided Bengal (1937-1943).
 - He took an active part in founding the All India Muslim league at Dacca on 30 December 1906.
 - As a member of the Indian National Congress, he was also actively connected with that organization. Huq was one of those who were instrumental in formulating the Lucknow Pact of 1916 between Congress and the Muslim League.

- In 1935, under Huq's leadership, the Krishak Praja Party started a mass movement with the objectives of the restoration of peasant rights, relieving the peasants of the oppressions of moneylenders and zamindars, and making raiyats proprietors of land by abolishing the zamindari system.

Q 29.C

- **During the Second World War**, the British government, under the **vicerealty of Lord Linlithgow** had said that any move towards an Indian statehood would be possible only if the Indian National Congress (INC) and the Muslim League resolve their differences.
- **The League was increasingly demanding a separate nation of Pakistan for the Muslims whereas the INC was against the partitioning of the country.**
- **To break this deadlock** between the two major political parties in India, C Rajagopalachari, INC member who was close to Mahatma Gandhi, proposed a set of plans called the **C. R. Formula or Rajaji Formula in 1944. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **The proposals are:**
 - The Muslim League would join hands with the INC to demand independence from the British.
 - Both parties would cooperate and form a provisional government at the centre.
 - After the war, a commission would be entrusted with the task of demarcating those areas with an absolute majority of Muslims and a **plebiscite to be held** in those areas where all the inhabitants (Muslims and non-Muslims) would vote **based on adult suffrage whether to form a separate sovereign nation** or not.
 - **In case of partition, joint agreements to be made for the safeguarding of defence, communications and commerce. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - The above terms come to fruition only if Britain transfers full powers to India.
- The talks were a failure as Jinnah had objections to the proposal. Jinnah's objections are that he wanted the INC to accept the Two-Nation Theory and he did not want the entire population of the Muslim majority areas to vote on the plebiscite, but only the Muslim population in those areas.
- **V D Savarkar and Shyama Prasad Mukherjee of the Hindu Mahasabha and Srinivas Sastri of the National Liberal Federation were against the C R Formula. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Q 30.A

- The **Non-Cooperation movement launched in the 1920s** influenced the people in princely states. The result of this impact where the establishment of **praja mandals (states' people's conferences)** in states like Mysore, Hyderabad, Baroda, the Kathiawad States and Deccan states. This process culminated in to the establishment of the **the All India States' People's Conference (AISPC) in December 1927.** The AISPC **opposed the provisions of the Government of India Act 1935** which gave princes the right to nominate the representatives to the proposed central legislature. It demanded that all representatives for the Federal Legislature should be on the basis of a popular elective principle. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- The **first session of the AISPC was held in Bombay.** It was attended by 700 political workers from the states. The men chiefly responsible for this initiative were Balwantrai Mehta, Maniklal Kothari and G.R. Abhayankar. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- Quit India Movement was launched in **August 1942.** The **meeting of the AISPC was convened along with the All India Congress Committee session at Bombay** that announced the commencement of the Quit India Movement. In the meeting, it was made clear that now there was **no distinction to be made between the people of British India and the States: every Indian was to participate. Gandhiji and Jawaharlal Nehru both addressed the AISPC Standing Committee.** Gandhiji explained the implications of the Quit India Movement and told the Committee that henceforth there would be one movement. The movement in the States was now to be not only for the responsible government but for the independence of India and the integration of the states with British India. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 31.C

- **Why in News?** The Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) is planning to construct a ropeway from the Kamakhya Railway Station to the Kamakhya temple in Guwahati.
- **Kamakhya Temple:** It is situated on Nilachal Hill in the western part of Guwahati city in Assam. It is one of the **oldest of the 51 Shakti Peethas in India**. Hence, **statement 1 is correct**. The main temple is surrounded by individual temples dedicated to the ten Mahavidyas: Kali, Tara, Sodashi, Bhuvaneshwari, Bhairavi, Chhinnamasta, Dhumavati, Bagalamukhi, Matangi, and Kamalatmika.
- Being the center for Tantra worship this temple attracts thousands of tantra devotees in an annual festival known as the **Ambubachi Mela**. Another annual celebration is the **Manasha Puja**. Hence, **statement 2 is correct**.

Q 32.D

- **Ghadar means 'revolt' or rebellion. The Ghadar party (started in 1913) was a revolutionary group organized to overthrow British rule in India. It was organized by overseas Indian immigrants to Canada and the USA. It was clearly stated by the Ghadarites that their objective was the establishment of the independent republic of India. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - The party was organized around a weekly newspaper 'The Ghadar' which was published from its headquarters, the Yugantar Ashram in San Francisco.
 - The founding president of the Ghadar party was Sohan Singh Bhakna and Lala Hardayal was a co-founder of this party.
 - The leadership also included Bhagwan Singh, Barkatullah, and Ram Chandra. The Ghadar militants immediately began an extensive propaganda campaign against British rule.
 - They toured extensively, visiting mills and farms where most of the Punjabi immigrant labour worked.
- **The Ghadarites were secular in outlook. The nationalist salute 'Bande Mataram' (and not any Sikh religious greeting) was urged upon and adopted as the rallying cry of the Ghadar Movement. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - The Ghadarites sought to give a new meaning to religion as well. They urged that religion lay not in observing the outward forms such as those signified by long hair and Kirpan (sword), but in remaining true to the model of good behavior that was enjoined by all religious teachings.
- Ghadarites did not betray any narrow regional loyalties. Lokamanya Tilak, Aurobindo Ghose, Khudi Ram Bose, Kanhia Lal Dutt, and Savarkar were all the heroes of the Ghadars. **Rash Behari Bose was importuned and accepted as the leader of the abortive Ghadar revolt in 1915.**
- **Far from dwelling on the greatness of the Sikhs or the Punjabis, the Ghadars constantly criticized the loyalist role played by the Punjabis during 1857. Hence statement 3 is correct.**

Q 33.D

- Government repression and frustration caused by the failure of the leadership to provide a positive lead to the people ultimately resulted in revolutionary terrorism, The youth of Bengal found all avenues of peaceful protest and political action blocked and out of desperation they fell back upon individual heroic action and the cult of the bomb.
- **Yugantar wrote on 22 April, 1906 after the Barisal Conference : "The remedy lies with the people themselves. The 30 crores of people inhabiting India must raise their 60 crores of hands to stop this curse of oppression. Force must be stopped by force".**

Revolutionary Activities

- **Bengal**
 - 1902—First revolutionary groups in Midnapore and Calcutta(The Anushilan Samiti)
 - 1907—Attempt on life of the former Lt. governor of East Bengal and Assam.
 - **1908—Prafulla Chaki and Khudiram Bose attempt to murder Muzaffarpur Magistrate, Kingsford.**
 - 1908—Burrah dacoity by Dacca Anushilan.
 - **1912—Bomb thrown at Viceroy Hardinge by Rashbehari Bose and Sachin Sanyal.**
- **Maharashtra**
 - 1879—Ramosi Peasant Force by Vasudev Balwant Phadke.

- 1890s—Tilak's attempts to propagate militancy among the youth through Shivaji and Ganapati festivals, and his journals Kesari and Maharatta.
- **1897—Chapekar brothers kill Rand, the plague commissioner of Poona and Lt. Ayerst.**
- 1899—Mitra Mela—a secret society organised by Savarkar and his brother.
- 1904—Mitra Mela merged with Abhinav Bharat.
- 1909—District Magistrate of Nasik—Jackson—killed.
- **Revolutionary Activity Abroad**
 - 1905—Shyamji Krishnavarma set up Indian Home Rule Society and India House and brought out journal The Sociologist in London.
 - **1909—Madan Lal Dhingra murdered Curzon-Wyllie;** Madame Bhikaji Cama operated from Paris and Geneva and brought out journal Bande Mataram.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 34.C

- **Why in news?** Recently, the PM inaugurated the two-day National Labour Conference which included Labour Ministers and Labour Secretaries from Union Territories and States in Tirupati. The recently enacted four labour codes -- the Code on Wages, Industrial Relations Code, Social Security Code and the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code -- will replace 29 labour laws.
 - **Code on Wages, 2019:** Applying to all the employees in organized as well as unorganized sectors. Under these new codes, several aspects related to employment and work culture, in general, might change including the take-home salary of employees, working hours, and the number of weekdays.
 - **Code on Industrial Relations, 2020:** Employees in India may be able to enjoy a **four-day workweek from next year**, as opposed to the current five-day workweek. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.** In that case, however, employees **will have to work for 12 hours on those four days** since the labor ministry has clarified that even if the proposal comes through, the 48-hour weekly work requirement must be met.
 - **Code on Social Security, 2020:** The regulations restrict allowances to 50 percent, which implies that **half of the salary** would be basic wages and contribution to the provident fund is calculated as a percentage of basic wages that involves the basic pay and dearness allowance (DA). **Hence, statement 2 is correct.** Under the current labor regulations, the employer's percentage-based contribution towards the PF balance depends on the employee's basic pay and dearness allowance.

Q 35.A

- **Why in news?**
 - Recently, India and Bangladesh have finalized the text of the Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on interim water sharing of Kushiya river.
 - Kushiya River
 - The Kushiya River is a distributary river in Bangladesh and Assam, India.
 - **It forms on the India-Bangladesh border as a branch of the Barak River when the Barak separates into the Kushiya and Surma.**
 - **The waters of the Kushiya thus originate in the state of Nagaland in India and pick up tributaries from Manipur, Mizoram, and Assam.**
 - From its origin at the mouth of the Barak, also known as the Amlshid bifurcation point, the Kushiya flows westward forming the boundary between Assam, India, and the Sylhet District of Bangladesh. **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**
 - Altogether, the Kushiya runs about 160 kilometers.

Q 36.A

- **Congress Democratic Party or Democratic Swarajya Party was a group founded by Bal Gangadhar Tilak within Congress. In its manifesto published in 1920, it recognized equal religious freedom to all citizens and proclaimed adherence to the ideal of Hindu-Muslim unity.**
- Within the fold of Hindu society, secularism would imply the exercise and enjoyment of equality and equal rights by the backward castes along with the advanced.

- **The Manifesto of the Congress Democratic Party (1920) did not recognize caste distinctions in the matter of conferment of rights on individuals.**
- Tilak did not hold an anti-religious outlook in regard to the role of the state in religious matters.
- He did not want the state to promote, sponsor or favour a particular religion disfavoured another. But he held that the state should maintain religious freedom for all individual persons in its fold.
- **The Manifesto also pledged "securing for the labouring classes, agricultural and industrial, a fair share of the fruits of labour, a minimum wage, the relationship between capital and labour on an equitable basis, and promoting organizations for the purpose."**
 - The Manifesto also promised "taxation according to the capacity of various classes, corporations or individuals, so that the burden may be proportionate to the means or wealth of the taxpayers'. But, simultaneously, the Manifesto assured the promotion of swadeshi and the development of industries by all recognized methods, including state subsidies and protective tariffs.
 - The Manifesto also guaranteed agricultural development, an extension of irrigation, cooperative development, industrial and technical education suitable to the needs of the country, organised medical relief and encouragement to the indigenous system of medicine.
 - These all were welfare measures that would ensure a modicum of economic development and a standard of life for the majority of the country's population.
 - The Manifesto did not provide for the abolition of private property nor nationalization of industries, the hallmarks of the socialist economic system. Tilak's economic philosophy was thus broadly in conformity with the prevailing economic ideology of the Indian National Congress.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 37.C

- International Congress against Colonial Oppression was held in Brussels in February 1927. The basic objective of the Conference was to bring together the colonial people of Africa, Asia and Latin America struggling against imperialism and the working people of the capitalist countries fighting against capitalism. Nehru was elected one of the honorary presidents of the Conference along with Albert Einstein, Romain Rolland, Madame Sun Yat-Sen and George Lansbury.
- **The Brussels Conference decided to found the League Against Imperialism and for National Independence. Nehru was elected to the Executive Council of the League. The Congress also affiliated to the League as an associated member. Hence, statements 1 and 2 are correct.**
- At its Calcutta session, Congress declared that the Indian struggle was a part of the worldwide struggle against imperialism. It also decided to open a Foreign Department to develop contacts with other peoples and movements fighting against imperialism.

Q 38.C

- **Why in news?**
 - Recently, the government **has exempted Boeing 787 aircraft in India from complying with the indigenously developed GAGAN navigation** system until December 2025 as the aircraft manufacturer has said that it involves a major design change. The government wants Indian carriers to start using GAGAN so that it will help increase the scope of the navigation system.
- **Civil Aviation Policy 2016:** It says that all other aircraft have to comply with GAGAN. The deadline for aircraft in India to comply with GAGAN was January 1, 2019, which was first extended to June 30, 2020, and then to July 1, 2021.
- **Development:** GAGAN is an Indian Satellite Based Augmentation System **jointly developed by the Airports Authority of India (AAI) and the Indian Space Research Organisation. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Its main aim is passengers' safety by guiding pilots to precision landing on runways. It is the first such system developed for India and neighboring countries in the equatorial region.
- **GAGAN uses a system of ground stations:**
 - Based in Delhi, Guwahati, Kolkata, Ahmedabad, Thiruvananthapuram, Bengaluru, Jammu, and Port Blair to provide necessary augmentation to the GPS navigation signal.

- A network of precisely surveyed ground reference stations is strategically positioned across the country to collect GPS satellite data.
- The system will be interoperable with other international SBAS systems and provide seamless navigation across regional boundaries.
- The GAGAN Signal-In-Space (SIS) is available through GSAT-8 and GSAT-10.
- **There are only three other space-based augmentation systems available in the world which include:**
 - **Wide Area Augmentation System in the U.S**
 - **European Geostationary Navigation Overlay Service**
 - **Japan's Multi-functional Satellite Augmentation System. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- **Significance of GAGAN**
 - **Smaller airports will benefit:** Once fully rolled out, **it will make several smaller airports such as those in the Northeast capable of having compliant aircraft land in low-visibility scenarios. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
 - **Poor weather and low visibility:** This new technology provides a substantial operational benefit in poor weather and low visibility conditions.
 - **Tool to alert before the natural disaster:** AAI in coordination with the Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS) has implemented the GAGAN Message Service (GMS) through which alert messages to fishermen, farmers, and disaster-affected people will be sent on the occurrence of natural disasters, calamities, such as flood, earthquake, etc.
 - **Landing:** GAGAN helps aircraft with guided landing at airports that do not have instrument landing systems for low-visibility operations or an aid where two radio beams provide pilots with vertical and horizontal guidance during landing.
 - **Safety and Traffic management:** It helps the aviation industry in maintaining safety with increased traffic and reducing the infrastructure needed on the ground.
 - **Disaster management:** It aids during natural disasters like floods and earthquakes by sending messages to affected people.
 - **Other benefits:** Besides aviation, it provides services in forest management, railway signaling, and scientific research for atmospheric studies, natural resource and land management, location-based services, mobile, and tourism.
- **Satellite-based augmentation system (SBAS)**
 - The SBAS is a navigation system, which builds on the Global Navigation Satellite Systems (GLONASS), and adds to the accuracy and integrity of these navigation tools.
 - For aircraft operators, both civilian and military, it means that pilots can land aircraft at smaller airports and airstrips using navigation guidance without expensive instrument-based landing systems being installed on the ground.

Q 39.C

- **Mountbatten was appointed Viceroy to India to speed up the process of transfer of power** by the then British prime minister Clement Atlee.
- **Provisions of the Mountbatten Plan:**
 - British India was to be partitioned into **two dominions – India and Pakistan.**
 - **The constitution framed by the Constituent Assembly would not be applicable to the Muslim-majority areas (as these would become Pakistan).** The question of a separate constituent assembly for the Muslim-majority areas would be decided by these provinces.
 - **The princely states were given the choice to either remain independent or accede to India or Pakistan. The British suzerainty over these kingdoms was terminated. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **The privy purse was a specific amount of money that was to be paid annually by the Indian government to the rulers of princely states and their successors who had acceded to India.**
 - The privy purses were **guaranteed to these rulers under Article 291 of the Indian constitution.** These payments were tax-free and were to be paid from the Consolidated Fund of India.

- The privy purses continued to be **paid to the royal families until the 26th Amendment in 1971, by which all their privileges and allowances from the central government ceased to exist**, which was implemented after a two-year legal battle. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**
- **Hyderabad was the largest and richest of all princely states** and covered a large portion of the Deccan. **Mir Usman Ali was presiding over a largely Hindu population in the princely state.**
 - He was very clear on his **demand for an independent state and blatantly refused to join the Indian dominion. Things took a turn for the worse when armed fanatics (called Razakars) unleashed violence targeted at Hyderabad's Hindu residents. In September 1948, Indian troops were sent to Hyderabad under 'Operation Polo'.**
 - In an armed encounter that lasted for about four days, **the Indian army gained full control of the state and Hyderabad became an integral part of India.** Later, in an attempt to reward Nizam for his submission, he was made the governor of the state of Hyderabad. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 40.A

- Born in Kaya village in the Kushtia district of the undivided Bengal, part of present-day Bangladesh, in 1879, Jatindranath Mukherjee kindled the flame of revolution against the British colonial rule in the Indian subcontinent.
- Jatin envisioned a modern India – politically free, economically prosperous, and spiritually progressive. The epithet 'Bagha Jatin' was earned by young Jatindranath Mukherjee in 1906 when he fought with a Royal Bengal tiger alone for three hours and killed it with a dagger.
- During his teenage, Jatin was profoundly influenced by the Bhagavad Gita and the writings of Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay. **After completing school, Jatin enrolled in Central College of Calcutta. As a college student, Jatin participated in the relief work undertaken by the Ramakrishna Mission, on the streets of cholera-hit Calcutta.** There he came in contact with Sister Nivedita, the Irish disciple of Swami Vivekananda.
- Jatindranath Mukherjee's meeting with Sri Aurobindo ignited his fervor for revolution against the British Raj. Soon Aurobindo considered Jatin as his right-hand man. **It was Sri Aurobindo who entrusted Jatin with the crucial task of creating a "network of the secret society" to train dedicated youth for the revolution against the British. That secret society came to be known as Jugantar, and Bagha Jatin became its commander-in-chief.**
- The nation was seething with discontent against the British Raj. It was at that time that Jatin's clarion call "Amra morbo, jagat jagbe" (We shall die to awaken the nation) evoked the rising currents of Indian nationalism. Thousands of young revolutionaries joined Jatin's brand of the freedom movement.
- **Jugantar, which soon became a pan-India movement, galvanized the spirit of strident nationalism.** Jugantar Party successfully set up its units across India and even spread far across southeast Asia, Europe, and America. The mounting serial attacks on British Raj by Jugantar shook the colonial administration right to London.
- **Jatin was arrested in the Alipore bomb case but released soon. Then he was arrested again in connection with the Howrah conspiracy case and locked in Howrah jail. While in Howrah jail, he came in contact with fellow revolutionaries — belonging to various groups — who were operating in different parts of Bengal. After spending 11 months in jail, Jatin was acquitted and released from jail in 1911.**
 - **The Howrah-Sibpur Conspiracy case refers to the arrest and trials of 47 Bengali Indian nationalists of the Anushilan Samiti that followed in the wake of the murder of Inspector Shamsul Alam on 24 January 1910 in Calcutta.**
- Jatin was in touch with Indian revolutionaries like Rash Behari Bose, Lala Har Dayal, MN Roy, Chempakaraman Pillai, Nair San, and Shyamji Krishna Varma, who was working for Indian independence from overseas.
- **In 1912, Jatin met the German Crown Prince in Kolkata and asked him for arms for an insurrection, in order to create a socialist government in India. The German Crown Prince promised to provide arms and funds for the proposed Indian insurrection against the British.**
 - The task of obtaining funds and armaments was entrusted to MN Roy, the key lieutenant of Jatin. In April 1915, Roy left India in search of German armaments which were believed to be en route,

somewhere in the Pacific. The plan was indeed fantastic. Bagha Jatin had plans to sever communications between Madras and Bengal.

- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 41.C

- **What is Paddy Dwarfing?**
- The characteristic symptoms of rice dwarf disease are stunting of the plant and the appearance of white chlorotic specks on foliage. The height of the stunted plants showed a reduction from 1/2 to 1/3rd of the normal plants. These plants had shallow roots and could be easily uprooted. Such plants were observed in almost all the cultivated varieties in the farmers' fields. Dwarfing of plants was reported at 10% to 25% in general and in some cases, it exceeded 40%. The incidence of stunting was more pronounced in early sown paddy crops, irrespective of the variety.
- **What is SRBSDV?** Southern rice black-streaked dwarf virus (SRBSDV), named after Southern China where it was first reported in 2001. It is a non-enveloped icosahedral virus with a genome of 10 double-stranded Ribonucleic Acid RNA segments and is a novel species in the genus Fijivirus (family Reoviridae). **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The SRBSDV is transmitted by a **white-backed plant hopper (WBPH)** in a persistent circulative and propagative manner. In addition to rice, SRBSDV also infects different weed species as nymphs of WBPH can transmit the virus more efficiently as compared to adults. Long-distance transmission of this virus may occur through WBPH migrating with typhoons and strong convection winds. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **What Could be Done for Prevention?** Since there is no corrective measure for the viral disease, farmers should regularly monitor the crop for the presence of WBPH, and a few plants should be slightly tilted and tapped 2-3 times at the base at weekly intervals. If WBPH nymphs/adults are seen floating on water, then insecticides can be sprayed towards the base of the plants. The farmers are advised to follow the transplanting dates advised by Punjab Agricultural University PAU since stunting was observed to be more in the early transplanted crops. It will not only help in managing viral disease but also save water.

Q 42.C

- **Subhas Chandra Bose** was born in 1879 in Orissa. He was educated at Cambridge and joined the Imperial Civil Service (ICS). Following the Jallianwala Bagh massacre of 1919 and Mahatma Gandhi's rise to power in Indian politics, Subhas Bose resigned from his post and joined Congress in 1921. He was imprisoned between 1924 and 1927. **Chittaranjan Das was his political guru.**
- When World War II broke out in 1939, Subhash Chandra Bose advocated not to support the British in the war and instead to launch a mass movement by taking advantage of the situation. **In March 1940, Bose convened an Anti-Compromise Conference at Ramgarh.** It was a joint effort of the Forward Bloc founded by Bose and the Kisan Sabha. It was resolved in the conference that a worldwide struggle should be initiated in April 1940 urging the people not to co-operate with the British during the War either with men, money, or materials. It was resolved at the conference that a worldwide struggle should be launched on April 6. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Subhash Chandra Bose protested and tried to launch a satyagraha against a proposed **monument for Holwell in Calcutta along with the Muslim League.** The Holwell Monument was erected by G. Holwell at his cost at Calcutta in 1760 to commemorate those deceased in the Black Hole Tragedy (1756). The monument was a symbol representing the alleged savagery of the last Nawab of Bengal, Sirajuddowla.
- **Subhas Chandra Bose was arrested in July 1940** due to the above protest. Later released from prison and placed under house arrest in December 1940 after a hunger strike. In January 1941, it was reported that Bose had escaped. On January 26, 1941, he reached Peshawar under the pseudonym Ziauddin, helped by Bhagat Ram. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 43.B

- **In 1946, the Cabinet Mission was sent to India** by the British government to find a resolution to the conflict between the Indian National Congress (INC) and the Muslim League on the issue of independence. The two parties were the largest in India's Constituent Assembly.

- **The League wanted a separate homeland for the Muslims they called Pakistan while the INC wanted a united India.**
- **The Mission was not successful** since the League and the Congress could not agree on the point of a united India with a strong centre.
- Since the Mission failed, the **Muslim League announced 16th August as Direct Action Day and called for a general hartal in order to protest the INC's stand and demand vehemently a separate homeland. Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**
- The outcome of this Direct Action Day turned out to be extremely violent and took the lives of hundreds of people.
- **Direct Action Day – Outcome**
 - League leaders gave fiery speeches at the rally which got the massive crowd excited.
 - This was followed by **large-scale rioting in Calcutta**. Around 4000 people were killed on the first day. The riots involved killing, rape, forced conversions and looting.
 - This communal violence **soon spread to other parts of northern India particularly Bihar. Noakhali (now in Bangladesh) saw gruesome violence.**
 - The violence witnessed during and after the Direct Action Day has also been called **the Great Calcutta Killings**.
 - **All this bloodshed and communal tensions ultimately led to the INC's acceptance of the partition of the country in order to suppress the violence and chaos.**

Q 44.A

- The U-Go offensive, or Operation C was the **Japanese offensive** launched in March 1944 against forces of the British Empire in the **northeast Indian regions of Manipur and the Naga Hills** (then administered as part of Assam). **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**
- It was one of the last major Japanese offensives **during the Second World War**. By 1943, **the British forces were beginning to dominate in the skies with Royal Air Force (RAF) aircraft operating out of India**. While Japan had no original plans to invade India, Lieutenant General Renya Mutaguchi of the Japanese Army knew that an offensive into India was the only way he could eliminate the aerial threat.
- Also, Controlling north-eastern India would also create a larger buffer zone between India and Burma. The offensive culminated in the Battles of Imphal and Kohima, where the Japanese and their allies were first held and then pushed back.
- At the insistence of Bose, two brigades from the Indian National Army were also assigned to the attacks on Imphal from the south and east. The Japanese had originally intended using the INA as auxiliaries to their forces only, for reconnaissance and propaganda.

Q 45.B

- The **August Offer** was an offer announced by the **Viceroy Lord Linlithgow in August 1940** to get Indian support to the World War II. Earlier the British government had in September 1939 had declared India a party to World War II without consulting Indian opinion. Thus the Indians decided not to support the British war efforts. However, the initial success of Hitler against the allied powers compelled the British seek Indian support. The government came up with its own offer to get the cooperation of India in the war effort. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- Lord Wavell was the governor general of India during 1944-1947.
- The **August Offer for the first time explicitly promised dominion Status** for India. It also provided for expansion of viceroy's executive council which would have a majority of Indians. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- The **August Offer provided setting up of a constituent assembly** after the war where mainly Indians would decide the constitution according to their social, economic and political conceptions, subject to fulfilment of the obligation of the government regarding defence, minority rights, treaties with States, all India services. Thus, it **recognised the inherent right of the Indians to determine their future Constitution**. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 46.C

- **African 'orphan' Crop: Why in News?** Recently, Researchers have identified genes in Africa's local food crops that can improve resistance to drought.

- **About Orphan crops:** Orphan crops are nutritious local food crops that could play a crucial role in combating hunger. These crops are not traded internationally but have adapted themselves to grow in harsh weather conditions. **Crops:** Orphan crops like finger millets, little millet; African yam bean, jojoba, and jatropha are commonly found on the continent. **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**
- It is a solution to growing concerns of climate change hampering crop productivity. It had identified genes that were high temperature tolerant, had increased salinity adaptability, and had low water requirements that provided essential nutrition.
 - **Improve crop yield:** Incorporating these genes through hybridization might improve crop yield that is affected by increasing global temperatures and heat waves.
 - **Tackling Heatwaves:** Countries like India and Pakistan are also likely to be affected by prolonged heat waves.
 - **Role of Africa:** Africa is estimated to help meet 25 percent of the world population's food needs by 2050.

Q 47.A

- The Strong Thermal Emission Velocity Enhancement (STEVE) is a puzzling aurora-like phenomenon that leads into a purple streak of light. It is an atmospheric optical phenomenon that appears as a purple and green light ribbon in the sky **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - Auroras are caused by interaction of energetic particles of solar wind with atoms of upper atmosphere.
 - Aurora occurs primarily in high latitudes of both hemispheres.
- STEVE appears significantly lower in the atmosphere unlike the typical auroras. STEVE first appeared in 2017 and has been appearing often since. It has been observed in New Zealand, Canada, Alaska and UK between October to February. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 48.B

- The period between 1905 and 1920 of the freedom struggle is known as the period of the extremists. The extremists had a radical and militant approach in contrast to the Moderates of the earlier periods.
- Indian National Congress during the freedom struggle had many foreigners who were the presidents of Congress sessions. They are
 - **George Yule -1888**
 - **William Wedderburn -1889 and 1910**
 - Henry Cotton-1904
 - Alfred Webb -1894
 - **Annie Besant -1917**
- **George Yule was the fourth president of Congress. He was nominated for the coveted post in the 1888 Allahabad Congress, thereby becoming the first non-Indian to lead the party.**
 - He also helped the 1889 Congress deputation to England, which pressed upon the British public the need for political reforms in India. Yule also served as the president of the Indian Chamber of Commerce and as the Sheriff in Calcutta, remained a friend and supporting figure for the Congress party, as he continued to advocate the party's cause as a British Committee member in England.
- **Sir William Wedderburn** was born in March 1838 in Edinburgh, Scotland. He left for India in 1860 and began official duty at Dharwar as an Assistant Collector. He was appointed Acting Judicial Commissioner in Sind and Judge of the Sadar Court in 1874. In 1882 he became the District and Sessions Judge of Poona. At the time of his retirement in 1887, he was the Chief Secretary to the Government of Bombay.
 - He entered Parliament in 1893 as a Liberal member and sought to voice India's grievances in the House. He formed the Indian Parliamentary Committee with which he was associated as Chairman from 1893 to 1900.
 - **In 1895, Wedderburn represented India on the Welby Commission (i.e. Royal Commission) on Indian Expenditure. He also began participating in the activities of the Indian Famine Union set up in June 1901, for an investigation into famines and proposing preventive measures.**
 - **He presided over the 1889 and 1910 sessions of Congress.**
- **Annie Besant** was born in London on 1 October 1847. She first came to India on 16 November 1893. In October 1913 she spoke at a great public meeting in Madras recommending that there should be a Standing

Committee of the House of Commons for Indian affairs which would go into the question of how India might attain freedom.

- **She founded a weekly newspaper 'Commonweal' in January 1914 for her political work. In June 1914 she purchased the 'Madras Standard' and renamed it 'New India', which thereafter became her chosen organ for her tempestuous propaganda for India's freedom.**
- **In August 1917, she was made the President of the Calcutta Session of the Indian National Congress.**
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 49.B

- The extremist period of the Indian national movement broadly starts from 1905 -1919. This period of the Indian national movement witnessed a militant nationalist approach to political activities. Their mode of struggle was
 - Passive resistance
 - Mass Agitation
 - Self-reliance
- **Some of the prominent leaders of the extremist phase of the national movement are:**
 - Aurobindo Ghosh
 - Ashwini Kumar Dutt
 - Lala Lajpat Rai
 - Bal Gangadhar Tilak
 - **Bipin Chandra Pal**
 - Brahma Bandhav Upadhyay
 - Satish Chandra Mukherjee
 - Pulin Das
 - Ras Bihari Bose
 - Apurva Kumar Ghosh
 - Rajnikant Sen
- **Rahmat Ullah Sayani was born on 5 April, 1847 in Bombay. He was one of the two famous Muslim representatives, who attended the first session of the Indian National Congress in 1885, which was attended by 72 members only.**
 - **Later, he became the Mayor of the Bombay Municipal Corporation in 1888 and, in the same year, became a Member of Bombay Legislative Council.** He continued in the Bombay Legislative Council and was in that capacity till 1896.
 - Rahmatullah Mohammad Sayani also became a **member of the Imperial Legislative Council in 1896.** He worked hard for the promotion of religious harmony and peace among different sections of society. He belonged to the moderate faction of congress
 - When Sir Syed Ahmed Khan was campaigning against the Indian National Congress, he powerfully countered the campaign.
- **Ananda Mohan Bose** was born on 23 September 1847 in Mymensingh, Bengal in an upper-middle-class family. He was a leader of the Brahmo Samaj, pioneer of the freedom movement, an educationist, and a social reformer.
 - Bose's interest in the political scene in India may be dated from 1871 when he first met Surendranath Banerjea in England. On his return to India in 1874 and right up to the days of the Swadeshi movement in 1905, the two were closely associated in all their political enterprises.
 - With Surendranath as his mentor and through his own organizational ability, Ananda Mohan Bose set up a number of pioneering institutions. **The Calcutta Students Association was the earliest attempt made to organize students for constructive political work. The Indian Association was the first political organization at an All - India level to institute a vigorous constitutional agitation for the rights and privileges of the Indian citizens.**
 - **One of its by-products was the convening of the, first National Conference in 1883 which became a precursor of the Indian National Congress (1885).**

- **Bose was associated with the Congress since its inauguration and was elected President of its Madras Session in 1898.**
- Under his enlightened direction, the **Sadharan Brahmo Samaj, of which he was a joint founder (1878)**, became an active centre for the spread of education and social uplift.
- **A moderate and a constitutionalist in his political outlook, Bose was progressive and one of the earliest to have pleaded for large scale technical education and industrialization.**
- He is remembered in particular for the last speech that he made on 16 October 1905 at a public meeting organised in Calcutta to protest against the partition of Bengal.
- **Bipin Chandra Pal was born on 7th November 1858 in Poil village in Sylhet district in present-day Bangladesh. Bipin Chandra Pal is known as the ‘Father of Revolutionary Thoughts’ in India. He was also an eminent radical of his time.**
 - Bipin Chandra Pal used his profession of journalism in spreading patriotic awareness. He published a number of journals, weekly and books to spread Swaraj. **His prominent books include ‘Nationality and Empire’, ‘Indian nationalism’, ‘Swaraj and the Present Situation’, ‘The Soul of India’, ‘The Basis of Social Reform’, ‘The Hinduism’ and ‘The New Spirit’.**
 - He was also the editor of the ‘Democrat’, the ‘Independent’ and many other journals. **He also started journals like ‘Paridarsak’, ‘New India’, ‘Bande Mataram’ and ‘Swaraj’.**
 - **Bipin Chandra Pal was famous as one of the triumvirates of the three militant patriots popularly known as ‘Lal-Bal-Pal’. These three were responsible for initiating the first popular upsurge against the British colonial policy in the 1905 partition of Bengal.**
 - At the time of Bal Gangadhar Tilak’s arrest and government repression in 1907. He left for England where he was briefly associated with the radical India House and also founded the Swaraj journal.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 50.B

- Attempts were made to organise peasant associations in north Bihar, as early as 1919-1920. But during this period they remained sporadic and localized. The first successful attempt to organise peasant movement in Bihar was made towards the end of the twenties of this century. Swami Sahajanand Saraswati was the pioneer of this movement.
- **On 17 November, 1929, Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha (BPKS) was formed and Swami Sahajanand Saraswati became its founder President.** It was reorganized on 11 April 1936 through the efforts of Sahajanand and some other leaders among which Yadunandan Sharma, P.D. Tandon, Jai Prakash Narayan, Sudhin Pramanik, Narendra Dev, and N.G. Ranga were some of the prominent names.
- From 1933 to 1940 he was the most powerful voice of Kisan Sabha during which he championed abolition of zamindari system, became **the president of All India Kisan Sabha in Lucknow (1936)**, toured to different parts of the country to highlight kisan issues and mobilize them under their own organisation (Kisan Sabha). **Saraswati organised the Bakasht Movement in Bihar in 1937–1938. “Bakasht” means self-cultivated.** The movement was against the eviction of tenants from Bakasht lands by zamindars and led to the passing of the Bihar Tenancy Act and the Bakasht Land Tax
- He first joined hands with the Congress Socialists for the formation of the All India Kisan Sabha; then with Subhas Chandra Bose organized the Anti-Compromise Conference against the British and the Congress then worked with the Communist Party of India during the Second World War; and finally broke from them, too, to form an independent Kisan Sabha.
- **Ranganayakulu, Gogineni is popularly known as Acharya N.G. Ranga** was born on 7 November, 1900 at Nidubrolu in Bapatla taluk of Guntur District. N.G. Ranga emerged as a famous freedom fighter. He was a multifaceted personality. He was a true follower of Gandhian Ideology. He was a great champion of the peasant community. N. G. Ranga played a key role in the freedom struggle. He had undergone imprisonment many times. He went to England in 1920 to become an I.C.S. but under the influence of Gandhi, he did his higher studies in Economics and got his Doctorate for his Research on “The Economics of Handlooms” from Oxford University. **N.G. Ranga was the first general secretary of All India Kisan Sabha formed in 1936.**
- **Indulal Kanaiyalal Yagnik** was an Indian independence activist, a leader of the All India Kisan Sabha and one who led the Mahagujarat Movement, which spearheaded the demand for the separate statehood for

Gujarat on 8 August 1956. In 1921 he became the secretary of the Gujarat Pradesh Congress Committee. In October 1922 he started Gujarati monthly, Yugadharm. In 1942, he presided over the annual session of the Akhil Hind Kisan Sabha

- **Yadunandan Sharma, also known as Pandit Jadunandan Sharma**, was a well-known Indian freedom fighter, peasant leader and a nationalist from the state of Bihar. He began a movement against the zamindars and British administrators and fought for the rights of tillers at Reora in Gaya, which is also **addressed as the Reora Satyagraha**.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 51.B

- On January 25, 1931, Gandhi and all other members of the Congress Working Committee (CWC) were released unconditionally. The CWC authorised Gandhi to initiate discussions with the viceroy.
 - As a result of these discussions, a pact was signed between the viceroy, representing the British Indian Government, and Gandhi, representing the Indian people, in Delhi on March 5, 1931. This Delhi Pact, also known as the Gandhi-Irwin Pact, placed the Congress on an equal footing with the government.
- Viceroy Irwin on behalf of the government agreed on:
 - **immediate release of all political prisoners not convicted of violence**
 - remission of all fines not yet collected
 - return of all lands not yet sold to third parties
 - lenient treatment to those government servants who had resigned
 - **right to make salt in coastal villages for personal consumption (not for sale)**
 - right to peaceful and non-aggressive picketing
 - withdrawal of emergency ordinances.
- **The viceroy, however, turned down two of Gandhi's demands.**
 - **public enquiry into police excesses**
 - commutation of Bhagat Singh and his comrades' death sentence to life sentence.
- Gandhi on behalf of the Congress agreed: to suspend the civil disobedience movement and to participate in the next Round Table Conference on the constitutional question around the three linchpins of federation, Indian responsibility, and reservations and safeguards that may be necessary in India's interests.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 52.A

- **The idea of Bharat Mata was found mentioned in Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay's 'Bande Mataram' composed in 1875 and used in his famous novel Anandamath in 1882.**
 - The novel was set in the backdrop of the Bengal famine of 1770 and was among the earliest works of fiction with an anti-colonial theme. In Anandamath, the author for the first time referred to the nation as 'Mata' or Mother, evoking the powerful force of Shakti and merging it with a deep love for the motherland.
 - It is said that the novel, the poem, and the emotions it raised inspired artist Abanindranath Tagore so much that he decided to give the idea a form of art – and he painted 'Bharat Mata'.
 - **The leader of the Swadeshi movement in art was Abanindranath Tagore, who also led the Bengal school of Art. To oppose the partition of Bengal, Abanindranath painted the Banga Mata in 1906. He changed the name of the painting later to Bharat Mata.**
 - Bharat Mata personified a Bengali woman as a deity who was the mother of the nation and was depicted as showing power and love.
 - **She was depicted as a four-armed Hindu goddess wearing saffron-colored robes, holding a book, sheaves of rice, a mala, and a white cloth representing four attributes that were seen as objects of nationalist goals. These were food, cloth, learning and spiritual knowledge.**
 - A multi-talented man, Abanindranath was an arts and culture pioneer in 20th-century Bengal. **He was instrumental in the establishment of the Indian Society of Oriental Art and brought in the idea of 'Swadeshi' in Indian art.** He is hailed as one of the greatest icons of Indian modern art.

- However, Abanindranth wasn't just a painter. **He was also a published writer of children's books. Several of his works like Budo Angla, Khirer Putul, Shakuntala and Rajkahini are considered Bengali children's classics.**
- **Dwarkanath Tagore** is one of the first Indian industrialists and entrepreneurs, was the founder of the Jorasanko branch of the Tagore family, and is notable for making substantial contributions to the Bengal Renaissance. He is also the grandfather of Rabindranath Tagore.
- **Jamini Roy** was an Indian painter and one of the most famous pupils of Abanindranath Tagore.
- **Nandalal Bose** was a student of Abanindranath Tagore who made paintings in Indian style. His paintings uniquely depicted Indian cultural beliefs. Bose is also the artist who designed the cover page of the Indian Constitution.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 53.D

- **The 21st session of the Indian National Congress was held at Benares from Dec. 27-30, 1905. Gopal Krishna Gokhale was the president of this session. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- **The formal proclamation of the Swadeshi Movement took place on 7th August 1905 in a meeting held at the Calcutta Town Hall. The Boycott movement was also launched along with the Swadeshi movement. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- The division between extremists and moderates could also be felt for the first time in this session.
- **Lord Minto was the Viceroy of India from 1905 -1910. Lord Hardinge was the Viceroy of India from 1910-16. (Lord Curzon resigned in the year 1905 itself after which Lord Minto was appointed in the same year). Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 54.B

- During his lifetime, Bal Gangadhar Tilak had been tried for Sedition Charges three times by the British rulers in 1897, 1909, and 1916.
- On 30 April 1908, two youths, Prafulla Chaki and Khudiram Bose threw a bomb on a carriage at Muzzafarpur, to kill the Chief Presidency Magistrate Douglas Kingsford of Calcutta, but erroneously killed two women traveling in it. While Chaki committed suicide when caught, Bose was hanged. **Tilak, in his paper Kesari, defended the revolutionaries and called for immediate Swaraj or self-rule. The Government swiftly charged him with sedition. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- On 24 June 1908, Tilak was arrested from Bombay on a charge of sedition and 153A IPC in respect of two articles carried in Kesari on 12 May and 9 June 1908. The article dated 12 May was titled 'The Country's Misfortune' and that of 9 June has titled 'These Remedies Are Not Lasting'. His house in Poona was searched by the police that found a postcard with the names of two books on explosives written on it. The Chief Presidency Magistrate of Bombay declined an application for bail. The sanction for the prosecution was swiftly granted and Tilak was committed to stand trial at the sessions of the Bombay High Court.
- **Tilak was defended by Mohammed Ali Jinnah, later by Joseph Baptista, and later by himself assisted by a battery of counsel. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The special jury comprised seven Europeans and two Indians. Indian jurors returned a verdict of not guilty while the European jurors adjudged Tilak guilty.
- **Justice Davar awarded Tilak a sentence of six years' transportation and after some time Tilak was sent to a prison in Mandalay in Burma. Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 55.D

- The **Faizpur session** of the Indian National Congress was held in December 1936. It was the first session of the INC to be held in a village. The session was **presided by Jawaharlal Nehru.**
- This Faizpur session is notable for an **agrarian programme** adopted by the INC. The major features outlined in this programme included **50 per cent reduction in rent and revenue**, exemption of uneconomic holdings from rent and land tax, taxation on agricultural income, abolition of feudal levies and forced labour, cooperative farming, wiping out arrears of rent, modification of ejection laws, and recognition of peasant unions (Kisan Sabhas). **This programme was however silent on the issue of the abolition of Zamindari and Taluqdari systems. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**

- The **All India Kisan Sabha** was **founded** at the **Lucknow session of INC in April 1936**. Swami Sahjanand Saraswati was elected as the president and N.G. Ranga as the general secretary. The Kisan Sabha issued a 'Kisan manifesto' which influenced the agrarian programme of the INC. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 56.C

- Gandhiji launched the Civil Disobedience Movement with his famous Dandi March, which began on March 12, 1930, and ended on April 6.
 - **The interesting thing is that not a single woman had been included in the actual march. He had chosen 71 volunteers to march from Sabarmati Ashram in Ahmedabad to the coastal village of Dandi,** but not one was a woman. Sarojini Naidu joined the volunteers at Dandi and became the first woman to be arrested in the Salt Satyagraha but was not a Dandi marcher per se. **Hence statements 1 and 2 are correct.**
- Women Congress leaders such as **Kamaladevi Chattopadhyaya and Sarojini Naidu** are believed to have complained to Gandhiji about the exclusion of women. Within days of completing the Dandi March, Gandhiji issued a call to women to actively participate in the Civil Disobedience Movement.
 - **In a statement entitled "To The Women of India" that appeared in Young India on April 10, 1930, Mahatma Gandhi called upon women to come out on the streets and picket liquor and foreign cloth shops. Gandhiji was very keen that the Civil Disobedience Movement should draw in the vast masses of India but should not turn violent or get out of his control.**
- Following this call, the trickle of women who had so far participated in the national movement turned into a torrent. Thousands of women got involved in the Salt Satyagraha, manufacturing and selling salt all over the country. Along with the illegal manufacture and sale of salt, the Civil Disobedience Movement included the boycotting of government functions and institutions, picketing of shops selling liquor and foreign cloth, and non-payment of revenue and chowkidar tax.
- **Sarojini Naidu led the protest at the Dharasana Salt Works, but another glorious group of marching women made its way to Chowpatty Beach on the same day that Gandhi made salt at Dandi, led by the feisty Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay.**

Q 57.B

- **Ram Prasad Bismil got his name etched as a prominent freedom fighter with his participation in the Mainpuri conspiracy of 1918. Bismil along with Genda Lal Dixit, a school teacher from Auraiya, organized youth from Etahwah, Mainpuri, Agra, and Shahjahanpur districts to strengthen their organizations, 'Matrivedi' and 'Shivaji Samiti'.**
 - **He published a pamphlet titled 'Deshwasiyon ke Naam' and distributed it along with his poem 'Mainpuri ki Pratigya' on January 28, 1918. To collect funds for the parties, they looted government coffers.**
 - The famous works of Bismil include 'Sarfarooshi Ki Tamanna' and the song 'Mera Rang De Basanti Chola' which he wrote while residing in Jail.
 - Police searched for them in and around Mainpuri. When he was planning another looting between Delhi and Agra, a police team arrived and firing started from both sides. Bismil jumped into the river Yamuna and swam underwater. The police thought that he had died in the encounter. Dixit was arrested along with his other companions and he was kept in Agra fort from which Dixit later fled and lived underground in Delhi. **A criminal case was filed against them. It is known as the "Mainpuri Conspiracy" against the British King Emperor.**
 - His ideals of freedom struggle stood in stark contrast to that of Mahatma Gandhi and he would reportedly say "independence would not be achieved by means of non-violence". After conflicting views and growing resentment with the Congress party, he formed the Hindustan Republic Association which soon had leaders like Bhagat Singh and Chandrashekhar Azad.
 - On August 9, 1925, Ram Prasad Bismil along with companions Ashfaqulla Khan and others executed the plan of looting the train at Kakori near Lucknow. After the revolutionaries stopped the 8-Down

Saharanpur Lucknow passenger train at Kakori, Ashfaqullah Khan, Sachindra Bakshi, Rajendra Lahiri, and Ram Prasad Bismil subdued the guard and looted cash meant for the treasury.

- Soon the British government cracked down on the Kakori conspirators, and arrest warrants were issued. While Chandrasekhar Azad managed to evade the crackdown, Bismil was arrested along with Ashfaqullah Khan, his close associate. After a long trial that lasted for a year and a half, Bismil, along with Ashfaqullah, Roshan Singh, and Rajendra Lahiri were sentenced to death.
- At the very young age of 30, the British government executed him on 19 December 1927 in Gorakhpur Jail.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 58.D

- **Desai – Liaquat Pact was between Bhulabhai Desai of Congress and Liaquat Ali Khan of the Muslim League in 1945.** The intention to **negotiate an agreement for a future coalition government**, which would enable **a united choice for Hindus and Muslims for the independent Government of India**; eventually in the direction of **ending the deadlock** between the two entities.
- **Bhulabhai Desai was the leader of the Congress Party in the Central Legislative Assembly and Liaquat Ali Khan was the deputy leader of the Muslim League in that Assembly. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Both of them came up with the **draft proposal for the formation of an interim government at the centre**, consisting of
 - **an equal number of persons nominated by the Congress and the Muslim League in the central legislature. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - 20% reserved seats for minorities.
- No settlement could be reached between the Congress and the League on these lines, but the fact that a sort of parity between the Congress and the League was decided upon had far-reaching consequences.
- The Conservative government in Britain led by Churchill was keen to reach a solution on the constitutional question in India. The viceroy, Lord Wavell was permitted to start negotiations with Indian leaders. Congress leaders were released from jails in June 1945. **The Wavell Plan was first presented at the Shimla Conference in 1945.** It was named after Viceroy of India, Lord Wavell. The Shimla Conference was convened in order to agree on the Wavell Plan for Indian self-government, which provided for separate representations on communal lines. **Desai Liaquat Pact was announced after rejection of C R Formula and before the Wavell Plan. Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- **Proposals of Wavell Plan are:**
 - **All members of the executive council, with the exception of the governor-general and the commander-in-chief, were to be Indians. Caste Hindus and Muslims were to be represented equally.**
 - The reconstructed council was to function as an interim government within the **framework of the 1935 Act** (i.e., not accountable to the Central Assembly).
 - The governor-general was to exercise his veto on ministerial advice.

Q 59.D

- In response to the inadequacy of the Simon Report, the Labour Government, which had come to power under Ramsay MacDonald in 1929, decided to hold a series of Round Table Conferences in London.
- **The first Round Table Conference convened from 12 November 1930 to 19 January 1931. Prior to the Conference, M. K. Gandhi had initiated the Civil Disobedience Movement on behalf of the Indian National Congress.** Consequently, since many of the Congress' leaders were in jail, Congress did not participate in the first conference, but representatives from all other Indian parties and a number of Princes did.
 - The outcomes of the first Round Table Conference were minimal: India was to develop into a federation, safeguards regarding defence and finance were agreed and other departments were to be transferred. However, little was done to implement these recommendations and civil disobedience continued in India.

- **The second Round Table Conference was held in London from 7 September 1931 to 1 December 1931 with the participation of Gandhi and the Indian National Congress.** Two weeks before the Conference convened, the Labour government had been replaced by the Conservatives.
 - At the conference, Gandhi claimed to represent all people of India. This view, however, was not shared by other delegates. In fact, the division between the many attending groups was one of the reasons why the outcomes of the second Round Table Conference were again no substantial results regarding India's constitutional future. Meanwhile, civil unrest had spread throughout India again, and upon return to India Gandhi was arrested along with other Congress leaders.
- **The third Round Table Conference (17 November 1932 - 24 December 1932) was not attended by the Indian National Congress and Gandhi. Many other Indian leaders were also absent.**
 - Like the two first conferences, little was achieved. The recommendations were published in a White Paper in March 1933 and debated in Parliament afterwards. A Joint Select Committee was formed to analyse the recommendations and formulate a new Act for India. The Committee produced a draft Bill in February 1935 which was enforced as the Government of India Act of 1935 in July 1935.
- **B.R Ambedkar, Tej Bahadur Sapru and Narayan Malhar Joshi attended all three round table conferences.** In all the round table conferences, B.R Ambedkar represented depressed classes. Tej Bahadur Sapru represented the liberals in all round table conferences. Narayan Malhar Joshi represented the labour class in all round table conferences.
 - Narayan Malhar Joshi also known as Nana Saheb Joshi was born on 5 June 1879 at Goregaon, Kolaba district,. He co-founded the All India Trade Union Congress in 1920, was a member of the Bombay Provincial Congress Committee, and was a prominent member of the People's Volunteer Brigade.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 60.D

- The idea of creating an army out of the Indian prisoners of war (POWs) was **originally that of captain Mohan Singh** an Indian army officer who had decided not to join the retreating British army in Malaya. The Japanese handed over the Indian prisoners of war to Mohan Singh who tried to recruit them into an Indian National Army. However decision to **establish the Indian National Army was taken at the Bangkok Conference (1942)**. The conference **elected Rash Behari Bose as the President of the Indian independence league**. The conference also decided to place the INA under an Indian Independence League. Thus Ras Behari Bose also played a significant role in the early phase of INA. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Subhash Chandra Bose arrived in Singapore in 1943 to lead the INA.** Here, **Rash Behari Bose transferred the control and leadership of the Indian Independence League and the INA to Subhash Bose** in July 1943. Subhash Bose became Supreme Commander of the INA on August 25. On October 21, 1943, Subhash Bose formed the Provisional Government for Free India at Singapore. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The INA headquarters was shifted to Rangoon (in Burma) in January 1944, and the army recruits were to march from there with the war cry "Chalo Delhi!" on their lips. **On November 6, 1943, Andaman and Nicobar islands was given by the Japanese army to the INA.** One INA battalion commanded by Shah Nawaz was allowed to accompany the Japanese Army to the Indo-Burma front and participate in the Imphal campaign. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Q 61.B

- **Sachindra Nath Sanyal** was the founder of the Hindustan Republican Association. He was sent to the dreaded Cellular Jail in the Andamans and in jail he wrote the famous book "**Bandi Jiwan**" (A Life of Captivity). This book would become the bible for a generation of revolutionaries fighting British rule. **Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
- **The Philosophy of Bomb** was written by **Bhagwati Charan Vohra** in response to Mahatma Gandhi's article the Cult of Bomb. **Hence pair 2 is not correctly matched.**
- **Pather Dabi** is a Bengali novel written by **Sarath Chandra Chattopadhyay** published between 1922-26. The book is about a secret society named Pather Dabi whose goal is to free India from British rule. **Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**

Q 62.A

- **The jurisprudence of bail:** Recently, the Supreme Court has reiterated that bail is the rule and jail is the exception.
- **Meaning of bail: Releasing a prisoner.**
- Bail connotes the process of procuring the release of an accused charged with certain offenses by ensuring his future attendance in the court for trial and compelling him to remain within the jurisdiction of the court. In simple words, it is the security required by a court for the release of a prisoner who must appear at a future time. The objective of arrest is to deliver justice by presenting the accused before the Court. However, if the same objective can be achieved without making any arrest then there is no need to violate his liberty. That's why bail can be granted to the accused person for conditional release.
- **The legal position of bail: Article 21 of the Indian Constitution** guarantees the protection of life and personal liberty to all persons. It guarantees the fundamental right to live with human dignity and personal liberty, which in turn gives us the right to ask for bail when arrested by any law enforcement authority.
- **Section 438 of the Code of Criminal Procedure in 1973:** The provision of anticipatory bail under Section 438 was introduced in the Code of Criminal Procedure in 1973. The term '**Bail**' has not been defined under the Criminal Procedure Code, 1973. Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.
- Only the term 'Bailable Offence' and 'Non-Bailable Offence' has been defined under Section 2(a). It is based on the recommendation of the Law Commission of India, which in its 41st report recommended the incorporation of a provision of anticipatory bail.
- **Categories of bail:**
 - **Bailable offenses:** According to Section 2(a) of CrPC means an offense that is classified as bailable in the First Schedule of the Code, or which is classified as bailable under any other law. An accused can claim bail as a matter of right if he is accused of committing a bailable offense. The police officer or any other authority has no right to reject the bail if the accused is ready to furnish bail. Under Section 436 of CrPC 1973, a person accused of a bailable offense at any time while under arrest without a warrant and at any stage of the proceedings has the right to be released on bail.
 - **Non-bailable offenses:** Non-bailable offense is defined as any offense which is not a bailable offense. A person accused of a non-bailable offense cannot claim bail as a right. A person accused of non-bailable offenses can be granted bail provided the accused does not qualify for the following conditions: There are reasonable grounds to believe that he has committed an offense punishable with the death penalty or life imprisonment. That the accused has committed a cognizable offense and he had been previously convicted of an offense punishable with death, imprisonment for life, or imprisonment of seven years or more, or if the accused has been convicted on two or more instances of a cognizable and non-bailable offense.
- **Different types of bail:**
 - **Regular bail:** The court orders the release of a person who is under arrest, from police custody after paying the amount as bail money. An accused can apply for regular bail under Sections 437 and 439 of CrPC.
 - **Interim bail:** This is a direct order by the court to provide temporary and short-term bail to the accused until his regular or anticipatory bail application is pending before the court.
 - **Anticipatory bail:** This is a direct order of Sessions or the High Court to provide pre-arrest bail to an accused of a crime. When the person has an apprehension of being arrested, the person can apply for anticipatory bail.
- **The distinction between Bail and anticipatory bail:** Under section 437 of the code, it has been stated that a regular bail is available and granted to a person after the arrest when he is in judicial or police custody, however in the case of anticipatory bail is available to a person before the arrest or if the person has a reasonable apprehension of the arrest.

Q 63.A

- **Why in news?** India is to develop two hydropower projects in Nepal, namely the West Seti Hydropower Project and the Seti River Hydropower Project.

- **Seti River:** The Seti Gandaki River is also known as the Seti River or the Seti Khola. The Seti river is a river in western Nepal. It originates from the glaciers around the twin peaks of Api and Nampa on the south-facing slopes of the main Himalayas. The area is near the tri-junction of the borders of Nepal, India (Uttarakhand), and China. The river finally joins the Karnali or Ghagra River (which is Nepal's longest river).
- Hence option (a) is the correct answer.

Q 64.A

- During the Swadeshi movement, nationalists used literature to propagate the principles of the movement amongst the masses. It brought, in "the literature and the illiterate together".
 - **Dakhinaranjan Mitra Majumdar's collection of Bangla folk tales Thakurmar Jhuli: Banglar Rupkatha (Grandmother's Tales: Fairy Tales of Bengal), published in 1907 was one of them. Following the ideals of 'Swadeshi', Mitra Majumdar introduced the collection as an indigenous alternative to the children's stories produced by the West.**
- Several writers like Dakhinaranjan Mitra Majumdar, Upendrakishore Raychaudhuri, Rabindranath Tagore, and Abanindranath Tagore began writing for children. These writers also intended to inform the young generation about the rich tradition of the region. While some of the works were anthologies of oral folk tales, others were original creations that drew heavily from the folk tradition, thereby retaining the indigenous flavor.
- **Dakhinaranjan Mitra Majumdar's Thakurmar Jhuli: Banglar Rupkatha, a collection of children's oral folk tales, published in 1907, was also an attempt at this process of restoration of the cultural identity of the Bengalis.**
 - **Thakurmar Jhuli anthologizes the folk tales from the eastern Bengal region, specifically those from the Mymensingh region.**
 - This book came as a Swadeshi alternative to the children's stories that were produced by the West and were flooding the Indian market. While acknowledging the Bangiya Sahitya Parishad for inspiring his work, Mitra Majumdar in the "Author's Note" wrote that the work was an inspiration to return his Mother Language - Bangla - her long-lost treasures from the past.
- After Thakurmar Juli, Mitra Majumdar wrote several such collections.
 - **In 1909, Mitra Majumdar published Thakurdadar Jhuli: Banglar Kathasahitya (Grandfather's Bag: The Narrative Literature from Bengal), and Thandidir Thale (Grandmother's Bag).**
 - **In 1913, he published Dadamosahyer Thale: Banglar Rashakatha (Grandfather's Bag: The Humorous Tales of Bengal).**
- Hence option (a) is the correct answer

Q 65.C

- The **provincial autonomy provided under the Government of India Act 1935** was implemented in 1937. In February 1937 elections were held in eleven provinces—Madras, Central Provinces, Bihar, Orissa, United Provinces, Bombay Presidency, Assam, NWFP, Bengal, Punjab and Sindh.
- In its sessions at Lucknow in early 1936 and Faizpur in late 1937, the Congress decided to fight elections and postpone the decision on office acceptance to the postelection phase.
- The Indian National Congress won 716 out of 1,161 seats it contested. It got a **majority in all provinces**, except in Bengal, Assam, Punjab, Sindh and the NWFP, and emerged as the largest party in Bengal, Assam and the NWFP. Thus, **it formed ministries in Madras, Bombay, Central Provinces, Orissa, Bihar, United Province, North-West Frontier Province and Assam. In Punjab, the Unionist Party formed the government. In the province of Bengal Fazlul Huq of the Kishak Praja Party formed the government** along with the Muslim league. **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**
- However, the Congress Ministries resigned in 1939 as a protest against the policy of the British government to declare India as the party to the Second World War without consulting Indians.

Q 66.D

- **Sachchidananda Sinha** was born on 10th November 1871 in Arrah, in the erstwhile Bengal Presidency. In London, he was an active member of the British Committee on the Indian National Congress. He campaigned for the election of Dadabhai Naoroji to the House of Commons in 1892.

- In 1893, he enrolled himself at the Calcutta High Court and later practiced in Allahabad and Patna High Court.
- He played a crucial role in the formation of the Province of Bihar and Orissa. Sinha was associated with the Congress party between 1896 and 1919. During this time, he was an integral part of Bihar Provincial Congress Committee, serving as its Secretary and later as President.
- **From 1910-1930, Sinha was a member of the Imperial Legislative Council. He became the Deputy President of the Central Legislative Assembly in 1921.**
- He also held the office of the President in the Bihar and Orissa Legislative Council and served in the Bihar Legislative Assembly. Later, he became the first Indian ever to behold the portfolio of a Finance Member of a province.
- Sinha showed a keen interest in journalism and became the editor of the Hindustan Review, a monthly magazine.
- **Madan Mohan Malaviya, also called Mahamana was an Indian scholar, educational reformer, and a leader of the Indian nationalist movement.**
 - **He made his political debut at the 1886 Calcutta (Kolkata) session of the Indian National Congress. An industrious worker, he soon climbed the ranks in the party and was elected president of Congress four times. Malaviya also served on the Imperial Legislative Council (1909–20).**
 - A gifted orator, he participated actively in debates on issues including free and compulsory primary education, the prohibition on recruiting of Indian indentured labour in the British colonies, and the nationalization of railways.
 - **Though a strong supporter of Congress, Malaviya helped establish the Hindu Mahasabha in 1906, which brought diverse local Hindu nationalist movements together.**
 - Malaviya, who was keenly interested in uplifting the educational standards of the country, was the principal founder in 1916 of the Banaras Hindu University in Varanasi, a premier institution of learning in India.
 - **Malaviya's consciousness toward the public led to the launch of his own Hindi-language weekly, the Abhyudaya (1907), the Leader of Allahabad, an English-language daily (1909), and the Hindi monthly the Maryada (1910).**
- **Vijayaraghavachariar** was born on 18 June 1852 in the village of Pon Vilaindha Kalathur, in the district of Chengalpattu in the state of Madras Presidency.
 - After a successful career of a lawyer, he became a Member of the Legislature in Madras (Chennai) in 1895 and he served the people until 1901. It was in Chennai that he came into close contact with V.S.Srinivasa Sastri, C.Sankaran Nair, Sir V.Bhashyam Iyengar, and many other eminent citizens. He ensured that the Chairpersons of the Municipalities were elected. A number of resolutions were passed due to his efforts. **He was in the Imperial Legislature from 1913 for 3 years.**
 - **He was involved with the Indian National Congress from day one. It was during the formative period that Vijayaraghavachariar and his friends played a key role in making the Indian National Congress an eff political organization with a focus on national consciousness, unity and development.**
 - **He was appointed as a member of the Congress Propaganda Committee in 1899. It was at the Calcutta Session in 1906 that he moved the resolution relating to the Permanent Land Settlement of Land Tenures.**
 - C. Vijayaraghavachariar believed in gender equality and wanted women to be of the right age at the time of marriage. He was a classical liberal who believed in pragmatism.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 67.C

- Recent context: India adds 11 more wetlands to the list of Ramsar sites to make total 75 Ramsar sites covering an area of 13,26,677 ha in the country in the 75th year of Independence.
- **Tampara Lake:**
 - Tampara Lake is among the most prominent freshwater lakes in the **State of Odisha** situated in Ganjam district.

- The depression on the ground gradually filled with rainwater from catchment flow and was called “Tamp” by the British and subsequently termed “Tampira” by the locals.
- The wetland supports at least 60 species of birds, 46 species of fishes, at least 48 species of phytoplanktons, and more than seven species of terrestrial plants and macrophytes.
- The wetland is an important habitat for vulnerable species such as *Cyprinus carpio*, common pochard (*Aythya ferina*), and river tern (*Sterna aurantia*).
- **Ansupa Lake:**
 - **Ansupa Lake is the largest freshwater lake of Odisha situated in Cuttack district and has its fame from time immemorial for its scenic beauty, biodiversity, and natural resources.**
 - The wetland is an oxbow lake formed by River Mahanadi and is spread over an area of 231 ha.
 - The wetland is home to at least 194 species of birds, 61 species of fishes and 26 species of mammals in addition to 244 species of macrophytes.
 - The wetland provides a safe habitat to at least three threatened bird species- *Rynchops albicollis* (EN), *Sterna acuticauda* (EN) and *Sterna aurantia* (VU) and three threatened fish species- *Clarias magur* (Clariidae) (EN), *Cyprinus carpio* (Cyprinidae) (VU) and *Wallago attu* (VU).
- **Nanda Lake:**
 - **Nanda lake in Curchorem is Goa’s first Ramsar site.**
 - Nanda Lake comprises intermittent freshwater marshes that lie adjacent to one of the major tributaries of the Zuari River. They are linked to the adjacent river channel by a sluice gate, which when closed enables the flooding of the marshes.
 - This wetland supports a wide variety of migratory waterbirds and many other important plants and animals.
 - Notable bird species include black-headed ibis (*Threskiornis melanocephalus*), common kingfisher (*Alcedo atthis*), wire-tailed swallow (*Hirundo smithii*), bronze-winged jacana (*Metopidius indicus*), brahmyn kite (*Haliastur indus*), intermediate egret (*Ardea intermedia*), little cormorant (*Microcarbo niger*) and lesser whistling duck (*Dendrocygna javanica*).
- **Sirpur wetland:**
 - **The wetland is situated in Indore District in the state of Madhya Pradesh.**
 - Sirpur Wetland is a human-made wetland that has stabilized and acquired near-natural characteristics in the last two centuries.
 - Commonly named Pakshi Vihar (bird sanctuary), the Site is a shallow, alkaline, nutrient-rich lake that floods during the monsoon to a maximum depth of two metres.
 - It boasts a wealth of plants and animals including threatened species: it supports some 175 terrestrial plant species, six macrophytes, 30 natural and cultured fish species, eight reptiles, and amphibians.
 - Waterbirds congregate during the winter season; the Site supports 130 bird species in all, including residents and migrants such as common pochard (*Aythya ferina*), Egyptian vulture (*Neophron percnopterus*) and Indian river tern (*Sterna aurantia*).
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 68.B

- The **Muslim League observed ‘day of deliverance and thanksgiving’ on 22 December 1939** when the **Congress Ministries in the provinces resigned** in protest of the Viceroy’s decision to make India a party to the Second World War without duly consulting Indians. **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**
- On 3 September 1939, the then **Viceroy Lord Linlithgow** declared that India was at war with Nazi Germany during the Second World War, along with Britain. The decision to make India a party to war was taken without consulting Indian opinion. So as a protest against this decision the Indian National Congress called upon its members to resign from all its ministries on 22 October 1939.
- **Muhammad Ali Jinnah** the leader of the Muslim League called upon Indian Muslims to celebrate **22 December as ‘Deliverance Day’ from Congress**. In this announcement of 2 December, he appealed to the imperial officials “to enquire into the legitimate grievances of the Musalmans and the wrongs done to them by the outgoing Congress Ministry”.

Q 69.C

- **The Indian Independence Act 1947 of the Parliament of the United Kingdom** which came into force on 15th July 1947, stated that India would be free from British rule on 15th August 1947, exactly a month from then. The act also **agreed on the Partition of the provinces of British India into the two new nations of the Union of India and the Dominion of Pakistan.**
- In June 1947, **Britain commissioned Sir Cyril Radcliffe to head the two Boundary Commissions (one for Punjab and the other for Bengal)**, to determine which territories will be assigned to which nation. The Boundary Commission was asked to demarcate areas in Punjab based on religious majority. While defining the boundary, Radcliffe also took into consideration “natural boundaries, communications, watercourses and irrigation systems”, while paying heed to socio-political affairs. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **Each Boundary Commission had four representatives**, two from the Congress and two from the Muslim League and given the tension between the both, the decision regarding the boundary ultimately lay with Radcliffe. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- There was a delay in announcing the Boundary Commission Award (under Radcliffe); though the award was ready by August 12, 1947. Mountbatten decided to make it public after August 15 so that the British could escape all responsibility for disturbances.

Q 70.C

- The European indigo planters of Champaran, a district in the north-western part of Bihar, practised all types of oppression on the local Bihari peasants not very dissimilar from the earlier malpractices of planters in Bengal. Gandhiji assisted by Rajendra Prasad and others started an open enquiry into the real condition of the peasants. He thought the peasants of Champaran the virtues of Satyagraha which consisted of open, disciplined, non-violent non-cooperation with injustice against the indigo planters. The Government of Bihar took offence at Gandhian moves and prohibited them from pursuing their enquiry and arrested Gandhiji. Later the Government developed cold feet and **appointed an enquiry Committee (June 1917) with Gandhiji as one of the members.** **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The ameliorative enactment, **the Champaran Agrarian Act (1918) freed the tenants from the special imposts levied by the Indigo planters.** **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- Unfortunately, however, the Congress leaders did not follow up the matter to its logical condition by freeing the Champaran peasants from the excessive rents charged by the zamindars and exorbitant interest rates charged by the money lenders.

Q 71.D

- The **Working Committee of the Congress** at its meeting in New Delhi on the 17th and 19th of February 1929 appointed **the following persons with power to co-opt, to constitute the Foreign Cloth Boycott Committee:**
 - Mahatma Gandhi (Chairman)
 - Motilal Nehru
 - **Madan Mohan Malaviya**
 - Moulana Abul Kalam Azad
 - M.A Ansari
 - Jawaharlal Nehru
- **The Non-Cooperation Movement** was launched in 1920 and was called off in 1922. **Hence statement 1 is not correct and statement 2 is correct.**
- **The Committee was required to carry out the following item of the Congress programme:**
 - Inside and outside the legislatures methods suited to respective environments shall be immediately adopted to bring about a **boycott of foreign cloth** by advocating and stimulating the production and adoption of handspun and handwoven Khaddar.
 - **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- The Foreign Cloth Boycott Committee approached all the Municipalities and District Local Boards in India
 - To exempt Khadi from tax
 - To increase the tax on foreign cloth and Purchase only Khadi for their use.

Q 72.D

- In 1911 the Bengal partition was annulled and the capital was shifted from Calcutta to Delhi, East and West Bengal were reunited; Assam again became a chief commissionership, while Bihar and Orissa were separated to form a new province. Hence statement 2 is not correct and statement 3 is correct.
 - The aim was to combine appeasement of Bengali sentiment with administrative convenience. This end was achieved for a time, but the Bengali Muslims, having benefitted from the partition, were angry and disappointed.
- Lord Hardinge II was the Viceroy of India from 1910–16 (during the annulment). Hence statement 1 is not correct.
- Other events during his tenure
 - Creation of the Bengal Presidency (like Bombay and Madras) in 1911
 - Establishment of the Hindu Mahasabha (1915) by Madan Mohan Malaviya
 - The coronation durbar of King George V was held in Delhi (1911).
- One of the main reasons behind the annulment was to curb the revolutionary terrorism which has been increasing due to numerous secret organizations mushrooming in Bengal with the support of anti-partition sentiments of people.

Q 73.C

- The Naujawan Bharat Sabha was formed to channelize the militant nationalist movement on ideological lines in March 1926 by Bhagat Singh. In this task, he was ably assisted by Bhagwati Charan Vohra, Dhanwantri, Ehsan Elahi and others. Ram Krishna and Bhagat Singh became its first president and secretary respectively. Hence statement 1 is correct.
- The Sabha had two-fold objectives-social and political. The social objectives comprised the popularization of swadeshi goods, plain living, physical fitness, inculcation of the sense of brotherhood and the stimulation of interest in Indian languages and civilization.
- The political programme of the Sabha included the following:
 - to establish a completely independent republic of the labourers and peasants of the whole of India
 - to infuse a spirit of patriotism into the hearts of the youths of the country in order to establish a united Indian nation.
 - to organise the labourers and peasants.
- Later Naujawan Bharat Sabha actively collaborated with Kirti Kisan Party for the cause of workers and peasants from 1928 onwards to infuse a spirit of struggle and to make the peasantry and workers conscious of their rights, the Sabha took a very keen interest in organizing workers' and peasants' conferences on various issues. The bond between the Kirti party and the Naujawan Bharat Sabha was further strengthened when Sohan Singh Josh, leader of the Kirti party, was elected chairman of the Amritsar branch of the Sabha in July, 1928. Hence statement 2 is correct.

Q 74.C

- Corps of volunteers (or samitis as they were called) were a major form of mass mobilization widely used by the Swadeshi Movement. The Swadesh Bandhab Samiti set up by Ashwini Kumar Dutta, a school teacher, in Barisal was the most well-known volunteer organization of them all. Hence statement 1 is correct.
- Its main aim was to encourage the consumption of native products and boycott European goods. The British Indian Government of India of the newly formed Eastern Bengal and Assam banned the Swadesh Bandhab Samiti in the year 1908. He was deported to the United Provinces where Dutta was imprisoned at the Lucknow jail. Hence statement 2 is correct.
- Through the activities of this Samiti, whose 159 branches reached out to the remotest corners of the district, Dutta was able to generate an unparalleled mass following among the predominantly Muslim Peasantry of the region.
- The samitis took the Swadeshi message to the villages through magic lantern lectures and Swadeshi songs, gave physical and moral training to the members, did social work during famines and epidemics, organized schools, training in Swadeshi craft and arbitration courts.

- **Ashwini Kumar Dutta**, popularly known as Ashwini Dutta was a popular Indian freedom fighter, philanthropist, educationist, social reformer, and nationalist.
 - In 1887, Ashwini Kumar Dutta took the initiative to set up the District Board in Barisal. Dutta also established the Bakarganj Hitaishini Sabha as well as a girls' school in that year.
 - In the year 1888, Dutta was appointed as the Vice Chairman of Barisal Municipality. Later in 1889, he constructed the Brojomohun College.
 - Ashwini Kumar Dutta also undertook relief work after the cyclone in Barisal in 1919. At the Calcutta session of the Indian National Congress Party in the year 1921, he supported the non-violent Non-Cooperation Movement. Mohandas Gandhi, popularly known as Mahatma Gandhi, went in Barisal in the same year to respect the great leader. Ashwini Kumar Dutta also supported the workers of Assam Bengal Railway and Steamer Company who started a strike as a protest against the hostilities and violence on the workers of tea plantations of Assam in the year 1922.
 - Ashwini Kumar Dutta also wrote several books on philosophy, religion and patriotism in Bengali language.
 - **Some of his most well known books include, Bharatgeeti, Atmapratistha, Bhaktiyoga.**

Q 75.B

- **The Congress Working Committee was arrested** all together and imprisoned at various places after the announcement of the movement, **The British also banned the party and as the masses were leaderless the protest took a violent turn**, large-scale protests and demonstrations were held all over the country. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **Lord Linlithgow was the Viceroy of India from 1936-1944** and it is during his tenure Cripps mission was sent to India and Quit India movement was started. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- In order to showcase their stand with the fasting of Gandhiji on behalf of the Quit India movement in Jail, **The three members of the Viceroy's Executive Council, H.P. Modi, N.R. Sarkar and M.S. Aney resigned from the Viceroy's Executive Council. Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 76.B

- **Following the 1905 Partition of Bengal, (Banga-Bhang), the British regime let loose a cycle of repression throughout the country. In view of the significant participation of students in political agitation, the government, in 1906, under a new circular 'Risley Circular' (named after H.H. Risley, the then Secretary to the Government of India, responsible for mooted the idea) prohibited students' participation in politics or any other agitation.**
- The raising of slogans like 'Vande Mataram and Tilak Maharaj Ki Jai was made a punishable offense. Earlier, the provincial government of Bengal had issued a 'Carlyle Circular'; the Riley Circular was a modified version of the Carlyle Circular issued earlier in Bengal in October 1905.
- Maharshi Aurobindo Ghosh, in his article 'True Meaning of Risley Circular' in the newspaper Vande Mataram accused the imperial regime of trying to deprive the students of joining the patriotic stream, sentiment, and programs. The regime's true intent was to weaken the anti-imperialism agitation, Aurobindo asserted.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 77.A

- **The Kakori Train Robbery took place at Kakori, a village near Lucknow, on 9 August 1925.** On board the train was money that had been collected from various railway stations enroute and that was to be deposited at Lucknow.
 - **In a well-planned operation, Ramprasad Bismil** led a band of 10 revolutionary activists who stopped the train, subdued the train's guard and passengers, and forced open the safe in the guard's quarters before fleeing with the cash found within it. **The raiders were members of the newly established Hindustan Republican Association (HRA).**

- The first Hindustan Socialist Republican Association act that attracted some public attention was the way it avenged Lala Lajpat Rai's death. When the whole of India resented the visit of an "**all-white**" **Simon Commission** for constitutional stock-taking, the police severely lathi-charged a protest demonstration in Lahore, assaulting many, including its leading figure Lala Lajapati Roy- who later succumbed to his injuries.
 - To retaliate against this outrageous occurrence, the H.S.R.A. decided upon the assassination of the person responsible for Lalaji's death, namely, Mr. Scott, the superintendent of police, Lahore.
 - **In December 1928 Bhagat Singh and Rajguru, aided by Chandrasekhar Azad and Sukhdev killed John Saunders, the deputy superintendent of police, mistaking him for Scott.**
- Jatindranath Das was a bomb-maker of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association from Bengal.
 - He came in contact with many other revolutionaries like Sachindranath Sanyal. During that time, he learned to make bombs. Further, in 1925, he was arrested and sent to jail for the Kakori incident.
 - **Bhagat Singh was planning to destabilize British rule.** Accepting the call of Bhagat, Jatindra came from Kolkata to Agra. **The bomb made by Jatindra Nath was used by Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt in the assembly bomb case of 1929.**
 - On 14 June 1929, Jatindra was arrested and put in Lahore jail. He once expressed his displeasure against the inhuman treatment of the prisoners in jail.
 - **Jatindra Nath Das breathed his last on September 13, 1929, after a 63-day-long fast for protecting political prisoners from injustice.** Only 25 years old at the time, Das had undertaken this hunger strike along with Shaheed Bhagat Singh and other imprisoned freedom fighters in the Lahore Central Jail.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 78.B

- **Nilratan Sarkar was a versatile medical scientist who made so much contributions to medical education and the Swadeshi enterprise in Colonial Bengal.**
- **His entrepreneurship laid him to swadeshi industries like the National tannery Soap Factory, Rangamati Tea Company, Shoes Company etc.**
- He joined Calcutta Medical College for the M.B Degree which he passed with Distinction in 1888. His deep patriotism led him to join hands with Radhagobindo Kar and Suresh Prasad Sarbadhikari to establish a National Medical College at Belgachhia in 1916.
- For his versatile genius, he was appointed Vice Chancellor of Calcutta University between 1919-1921.
- **He was also instrumental in establishing the Bengal Technical Institute which blossomed into the College of Engineering and Technology of Jadavpur University later.**
- **He was an intimate friend of Acharya Prafulla Chandra Ray and substantially helped Ray AS Bengal Chemical & Pharmaceutical Works.** Sarkar, Roy, Kartik, Bose, and Satya Sundar Deb pioneered the Swadeshi economic revolution.
- **In 1890 he joined the Indian National Congress and remained its member till 1919. These were crucial years in Indian politics. The Moderates and Extremists had fallen apart leaving a void in national politics. Dr. Sarkar still served it as its sheet anchor. He became a member of the Bengal Legislative Assembly and served it between 1912 and 1927.**
- He was President of the Indian Medical Association for years, the Calcutta Medical Club which he started, Chittaranjan Seva Sadan, Chittaranjan Hospital, and Jadavpur Tuberculosis Hospital. He was also Editor-in-Chief of the Journal of Indian Medical Association.
- He was the Chairman of the first Governing Body of the Bose Institute, which is Asia's first modern interdisciplinary research centre. Sircar became the president of the Medical Education Society of Bengal in 1922 and remained in the position until 1941. He was one of the enthusiastic founding fathers of the Science College of the University of Calcutta. Sircar was involved in the formation of the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science and functioned as its President from 1939 to 1941.
- **In 1920 he traveled to England to represent the University of Calcutta at the Empire Universities Conference in London.**
- **Sir Jagadish Chandra Bose** is one of the most prominent first Indian scientists who proved by experimentation that both animals and plants share much in common.

- He demonstrated that plants are also sensitive to heat, cold, light, noise, and various other external stimuli. Bose contrived a very sophisticated instrument called the crescograph, which could record and observe plants' minute responses to external stimulants.
- Known as the “Father of Indian Chemistry”, **Prafulla Chandra Ray** was a well-known Indian scientist and teacher and one of the first “modern” Indian chemical researchers.
 - He discovered the stable compound mercurous nitrite in 1896 and established Bengal Chemical and Pharmaceutical Works Ltd, India's first pharmaceutical company in 1901.
 - His autobiography “Life and Experiences of a Bengali Chemist”, published in two volumes in 1932 and 1935 documents his own motivations as a scientist and the sweeping changes India was experiencing during his lifetime.
- **Meghnad Saha** was an outstanding Indian scientist. He made remarkable contributions to the field of Astrophysics.
 - In 1917, Meghnad Saha joined as a lecturer at the newly opened University College of Science in Calcutta. He taught Quantum Physics. Along with S.N. Bose, he translated the papers published in German by Einstein and Minkowski on relativity into English versions. In 1919, American Astrophysical Journal published - "On Selective Radiation Pressure and its the application" - a research paper by Meghnad Saha. He put forward an "ionization formula" which explained the presence of the spectral lines.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 79.A

- The **Dutt-Bradley thesis was a popular document for the Indian Communists** published by two British leaders R.P. Dutt and Ben Bradley in early 1936. This thesis advocated the **participation of the communists in the Indian National Movement**. According to this thesis, the **Indian National Congress** could play a ‘great part and a foremost part in the work of realizing the anti-imperialist people’s front. Thus, it **advocated cooperation between the Communists and the Indian National Congress**. **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- The thesis constitutes a landmark, in **Indian Communist** history, since it brought the Communist Party of India into the mainstream of the anti-imperialist struggle. The document helped the CPI to reforge its links with the national movement. Following this, the Congress Socialist Party, on the recommendation of its general secretary, Jaya Prakash Narayan, decided to admit communists to its membership.

Q 80.C

- **Lala Lajpat Rai was a prominent nationalist leader who played an important role in India’s struggle for freedom.** His fierce brand of patriotism and potent vocalism against British rule earned him the title of ‘**Punjab Kesari**’ or the **Lion of Punjab**.
- He, together with other prominent leaders like Bipin Chandra Pal, Aurobindo Ghosh from Bengal, and Bal Gangadhar Tilak from Maharashtra, began to see the negative aspects of moderate politics advocated by many leaders of the Indian National Congress. They voiced their strong opposition to the Congress’ demand for gradual progress to dominion status and began voicing the need for complete independence or ‘Purna Swaraj’.
- Lala Lajpat Rai gave up his legal practice and put all his efforts into freeing his Motherland from the shackles of British Imperialism.
 - He went to Britain in 1914 and then to the USA in 1917. **In October 1917, he founded the Indian Home Rule League of America in New York.** He stayed in the USA from 1917 to 1920.
- In 1920, after his return from America, Lajpat Rai was invited to preside over the special session of the Congress in Calcutta. He led fiery demonstrations against the British in Punjab in protest of their brutal actions at Jallianwallah Bagh.
 - When Gandhi launched the non-cooperation movement in 1920, he plunged into action leading the movement in Punjab. When Gandhi decided to suspend the movement post the Chauri Chaura incident, Lajpat Rai criticized the decision and went on to form the Congress Independence Party.

- **Servants Of the People Society was founded by Lala Lajpat Rai in 1921 at Lahore, and was inaugurated by Mahatma Gandhi on 9th November 1921.**
- On October 30, 1928, Lala Lajpat Rai led a peaceful procession to oppose the arrival of the Simon Commission in Lahore. Intercepting the march, Superintendent of Police, James A.Scott ordered his police force to 'lathi-charge' at the activists. The police targeted Lajpat Rai, in particular, and hit him in the chest. This action left Lala Lajpat Rai with severe injuries. He died of a heart attack on November 17, 1928.
 - His followers squarely placed the blame on the British and vowed to avenge his death. Chandrasekhar Azad along with Bhagat Singh and other associates plotted the assassination of Scott but the revolutionaries shot J.P. Saunders, mistaking him as Scott.
- **Lala Lajpat Rai's publications include :**
 - The Story of My Deportation (1908)
 - Arya Samaj (1915)
 - The United States of America: A Hindu's impressions (1916)
 - Young India; an interpretation and a history of the nationalist movement from within (1916). Hence statement 3 is correct.
 - England's Debt to India: India (1917)
- **The Social Service League was established in 1911 by Narayan Malhar Joshi.**
 - **It mainly worked for the improving condition of the common masses; opened schools, libraries etc.**
 - Narayan Malhar Joshi also known as Nana Saheb Joshi was born on 5 June 1879 at Goregaon, Kolaba district,. He co-founded the All India Trade Union Congress in 1920, was a member of the Bombay Provincial Congress Committee, and was a prominent member of the People's Volunteer Brigade(P V B).
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 81.B

- **The Bengal Provincial Conference of 1906 was held at Barisal some six months after the 'Partition' was put into effect.** Barisal was the headquarters of the Buckerganj district. The majority of the population was Muslim peasants and weavers. In 1905 there was drought and a near-famine condition prevailed in the district.
- Yet Barisal was selected as the venue with the expectation that this selection would promote the cause of Hindu-Muslim unity and the anti-partition movement.
- In Barisal, Aswinikumar Datta was consolidating his hold on the peasantry most of whom were Muslims, through famine relief work on an impressive scale. The message of Swadeshi was being spread through the jari songs composed by the Muslim folk poet.
- **The organizers of the Barisal conference were very keen on drawing in the Muslim masses. Even the conference was presided over by prominent Muslim leader Abdul Rasul. Thus it was not boycotted by Muslims. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- The Barisal conference was held as usual. About 300 delegates from all over Bengal attended the conference. Local delegates considerably exceeded that figure.
- **British became alarmed at the success of the Swadeshi boycott and the growing Hindu-Muslim unity. Naturally, the authorities tried to disperse the conference, and orders were issued accordingly. By a circular, the singing of "Bande Mataram" was banned in Barisal. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- After the conference was over the delegates headed by S.N. Banerji returned to Calcutta and received a magnificent ovation.
- **Moulavi Muzummar Rahaman and Moulavi Leakat Hossain, on behalf of the Mussalman community, expressed their great indignation at the cruelties perpetrated on the delegates at Barisal.**
- **The Conference and its immediate aftermath marked the highest level of Muslim participation in the Swadeshi movement. By the end of the year, there was, however, a visible turn in the tide.** Muslim enthusiasm for the movement was fast ebbing away. Communal tension began to rise, followed by communal riots in some of the districts of East Bengal, though Barisal was, fortunately, free from such ugly incidents.

Q 82.C

- **About the Ahmedabad Mill strike :**
 - In 1917 plague outbreak made the labor shortage more acute because it drove many workers away from Ahmedabad to the countryside. To dissuade the workers from leaving the town, the mill owners decided to pay the plague bonus which was sometimes as high as 75% of the normal wages of the workers.
 - **After the epidemic was over, the mill owners decided to discontinue the Plague Bonus. But the workers opposed the employers' move and argued that it was helping them to offset the wartime rise in the cost of living.** The mill owners were prepared to give a 20% increase but the workers were demanding a 50% raise in wages in view of the price hike. **Hence statement 1 is correct**
 - Gandhiji began the Satyagraha movement against the mill owners. The workers were asked to take a pledge stating that they would not resume work without a 35% increase and that they would remain law-abiding during the lockout.
 - Gandhiji, assisted by Anasuya Sarabhai organized daily mass meetings of workers, in which he delivered lectures and issued a series of leaflets on the situation. It was Gandhi's first Hunger strike in the Gandhian movements in India. **Hence statement 2 is correct**
 - Finally, the arbitrator's award went in favor of the workers and 35% raise was given to them.

Q 83.C

- The **Forward Bloc was formed in May 1939** by Subhash Chandra Bose and his followers a new party within the Congress. This development preceded the resignation of Subhash Chandra Bose in April 1939.
- **World war II** was triggered in **1939** when Germany attacked Poland on September 1, 1939. **On September 3, 1939**, Britain declared war against Germany and the British Government of India declared India's support for the war without consulting Indian opinion.
- **Chalo Delhi Movement** was triggered by the **Individual Satyagraha** launched in **October 1940**. The Individual satyagraha was launched to protest against the British decision to involve India in World War II. Vinoba Bhave was the first to offer the satyagraha and Nehru, was the second. The demand of the satyagrahi would be the freedom of speech against the war through an anti-war declaration. If the government did not arrest the satyagrahi, he or she would not only repeat it but move into villages and start a march towards Delhi, thus precipitating a movement which came to be known as the 'Delhi Chalo Movement'.
- **Hence, the correct sequence of events is 3-2-1.**

Q 84.A

- **The Darbar of 1911 marked the succession of King George V. This Durbar was historic for two reasons; one it was the only one attended by the Emperor himself and second, this was where the shifting of the Imperial Capital from Calcutta to Delhi was announced. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The Proclamation Ceremony took place on 12th December in the Durbar arena which had two amphitheatres on the same site as the previous Durbars. The larger, outer one called the Spectator's Mound was for the general public. The other smaller amphitheatre was reserved for the esteemed guests of the Durbar.
- **This Proclamation Ceremony of 1911 was much talked about for various reasons. Firstly, the Maharaja of Gaekwar after arriving at the amphitheatre removed all his jewellery except his Star and medals and handed them over to his son who was sitting behind him. This behaviour of the Maharaja was considered rude.**
 - Secondly, the planners of the Darbar had some idea long before the Ceremony that few Ruling Chiefs were not in favour of bowing before the Emperor for the Homage Ceremony. They were expected to bow three times before their Imperial Majesties and walk back to their places in reverse. They wanted to meet the Emperor but as equals.
 - Hence, on the day of the Ceremony, Maharaja of Gaekwar during his homage to the King and the Queen partly bowed, just once, turned around and walked to his place. His behaviour at the Delhi Durbar was written about in many newspapers as it was considered highly disrespectful on his part. He later apologized on the advice of the British Resident in his court.
 - **It soon came to be known as the 'Durbar Incident.** Reactions were swift and ranged all the way from calls for the Maharaja's dismissal to praise and the attempt to use the incident as a nationalist political rallying point against British rule.

- The planners of the Royal Durbar, led by Sir John Hewett, completed the symbolic relocation of the event by incorporating South Asian motifs throughout the design. **The architect of the Durbar arena, Sir Samuel Swinton Jacob, developed these motifs after touring the remains of important Indian architectural sites, including Fatehpur Sikri, Agra, and Delhi.** He eventually produced an amalgam, combining (in his view) the very best of ancient Hindu and Islamic art. He called this ensemble "Indo-Saracenic."
 - Ceremonially, too, the **planners tried to combine and incorporate the elements of as many Indian imperial traditions as possible.** When the King-Emperor arrived, for example, his progress to the Durbar site was along the Moghal via sacra, from the Red Fort's Delhi Gate, across the central plaissance, to the Jama Masjid, the largest mosque in South Asia. This was the route the Moghal emperors had used to attend Friday evening prayers. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 85.D

- **Starting with the Cripps mission in 1942, a number of attempts were made by colonial authorities to form an interim government in India. In 1946, elections to the Constituent Assembly** were held following the proposals of the British Cabinet Mission dispatched by the British Prime Minister Clement Attlee.
- In this election, the Congress obtained a majority in the Assembly, and the Muslim League consolidated its support among the Muslim electorate.
- **Viceroy Wavell subsequently called upon Indian representatives to join the interim government. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- A federal scheme had been visualised under the Government of India Act of 1935, but this component was never implemented due to the opposition from India's princely states. As a result, **the interim government functioned according to the older Government of India Act of 1919.**
- The **Interim Government** was formed as a **provisional government** between an imperial structure and a democratic structure. It **lasted till 15th August 1947 when India became independent and was partitioned into India and Pakistan.** Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru became Vice President of the Executive Council and served as the de-facto Prime Minister. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
- **Even though the Muslim League refused to be a part of the Interim Government, insisting on their demand for a separate nation, it eventually became a part of it. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**

Q 86.A

- **The 'Alipore Bomb Case' was "the first state trial of any magnitude in India". The British Government arrested Sri Aurobindo, a prominent Nationalist Leader at the time, Barindra Ghose, and many young revolutionaries. They were charged with "Conspiracy" or "waging war against the King.**
- The case was formally known as Emperor versus Aurobindo Ghosh and others " or the 'Alipore Bomb Case' as it was tried in the Alipore Sessions Court in Calcutta.
- **Most of the accused in the Alipore Bomb Case had been a part of the clandestine revolutionary group, Anushilan Samiti. Following their arrests, revolutionary activities in Bengal were taken over by the Jugantar group, led by the firebrand Jatindranath Mukherjee, aka Bagha Jatin. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - In 1909, they assassinated Ashutosh Biswas, the prosecutor in the Goswami murder case. The following year, Shamsul Alam, an investigator in the Alipore Bomb Case, as well as Naren Banerjee, Khudiram's arresting officer, were both assassinated.
- The historic trial took a year to complete and came to a close on 6th May 1909. Aurobindo Ghosh and 16 others were acquitted. Barin Ghosh and Ullaskar Dutt were sentenced to imprisonment and eventually released in 1920. Hemchandra Kanungo Das and a number of others were sentenced to transportation for life and forfeiture of all properties.
 - **Chittaranjan Das was the defense counsel of Aurobindo Ghosh in this case. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

- Undeterred by more arrests and prosecution, the group would go on to attempt the assassination of Viceroy Charles Hardinge, and try to execute a nationwide mutiny in 1914, Which came to be known as the Hindu-German Conspiracy.
- The Alipore Bomb Case first put the public spotlight on the Anushilan Samiti. Right from its founding in 1902, to its dissolution in the 1930s, almost every act of 'revolutionary terrorism' in Bengal was linked to this organization. While police repression put an end to the revolutionary moment in Bengal in the 1930s, the Alipore Bomb Case remained a landmark in Bengal's revolutionary struggle.

Q 87.A

- The **Lothian Committee** also called as the Indian Franchise Committee was constituted in 1932 **to decide on the matters concerning franchise**. The Lothian Committee rejected universal adult franchise but recommended that two to five per cent of seats in the provinces be reserved for women. The Communal Award was based on the findings of the Lothian Committee.
- The electoral provisions of the **Government of India Act, 1935** were also based on the Lothian Committee report. The Government of India Act, 1935 reserved seats for women on a communal basis while women could contest from any general seat as well.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 88.D

- **Meerut Conspiracy Case - Features**
 - **31 communists/labor leaders were arrested** in various parts of India on March 20, 1929. The majority of them were well-known individuals in the labor movement and trade unions.
 - Meerut was carefully chosen as the location for the trial. The authorities primarily desired to avoid a jury trial. The case would have been tried by the High Court with a jury in both Bombay and Calcutta, two major centers of communist activity.
 - Unlike in past 'communist conspiracy' cases, the Meerut inmates intended to use the court as a forum to spread their agenda as much as possible.
 - **Muzaffar Ahmad** urged Adhikari that they should use the Sessions Court as a forum for political declarations and that they should prepare themselves by studying.
 - **RS Nimbkar** publicly introduced the general statement on behalf of all the defendants.
 - The accused's "major achievements," according to the Additional Sessions Judge, were the "creation of the Workers and Peasants Parties."
 - The Meerut trial was perhaps remarkable in that it was accompanied by a significant solidarity initiative in the form of an organized campaign in India and overseas, mainly in the United Kingdom.
 - The arrests were condemned by the Comintern, and British workers and communists formed a strong solidarity campaign. They raised money for the detainees.
 - Throughout the **trial which lasted 3.5 years**, the radical British press raised the subject and expressed sympathy for the prisoners. This trail drew **sympathetic comments from H.G.Wells, Harold Laski, and President Roosevelt. Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**
 - **From 1929 to the end of 1933**, the Meerut prisoners' solidarity movement grew into a militant political force that aided in the formation of a favorable public attitude in support of India's battle for independence.
- The **Delhi Conspiracy case**, also known as the Delhi-Lahore Conspiracy, refers to an attempt made in 1912 to assassinate the then Viceroy of India, Lord Hardinge by throwing a local self-made bomb, on the occasion of transferring the capital of British India from Calcutta to New Delhi.
- **Peshawar Conspiracy Case (1922-1927 AD)** was a trial against the Mujahirs, who had tried to sneak into India from Russia in order to start a communist movement in India. There were five cases that continued from 1922 to 1927 AD.
- **Kanpur Bolshevik Conspiracy Case (1924 AD):** In this case, newly emerged communists of India were execrated by the British Government. M N Roy, Muzaffar Ahamed, S A Dange, Shaukat Usmani, Nalini Gupta, Singaravelu Chettiar, Ghulam Hussain were caught by the Government and were trailed for conspiring against the Government

Q 89.D

- **Swarajist Activity in Councils**
 - The government strategy of dividing the Swarajists—the more militant from the moderate, the Hindus from the Muslims—was successful. The Swarajists lost the support of many Muslims when the party did not support the tenants' cause against the zamindars in Bengal (most of the tenants were Muslims). Communal interests also entered the party.
 - The death of C.R. Das in 1925 weakened it further.
 - **The Responsivists among Swarajists**—Lala Lajpat Rai, Madan Mohan Malaviya, and N.C. Kelkar—advocated cooperation with the government and holding of office wherever possible. Besides, they also wanted to protect the so-called Hindu interests. The communal elements accused leaders like Motilal Nehru, who did not favor joining the council, of being anti-Hindu even as Muslim communalists called the Swarajists anti-Muslim.
 - Thus, the main leadership of the Swarajist Party reiterated faith in mass civil disobedience and withdrew from legislatures in March 1926, while another section of Swarajists went into the 1926 elections as a party in disarray and did not fare well on the whole. **They won 40 seats in the Centre and some seats in Madras but were routed in the United Provinces, the Central Provinces, and Punjab.**
 - In 1930, the Swarajists finally walked out as a result of the Lahore Congress resolution on purna swaraj and the beginning of the Civil Disobedience Movement.
 - **Achievements**
 - With coalition partners, they out-voted the government several times, even on matters relating to budgetary grants, and passed adjournment motions.
 - They agitated through powerful speeches on self-government, civil liberties, and industrialization.
 - **Vithalbhai Patel was elected speaker of the Central Legislative Assembly in 1925. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - A noteworthy achievement was the **defeat of the Public Safety Bill in 1928**, which was aimed at empowering the Government to deport undesirable and subversive foreigners (because the Government was alarmed by the spread of socialist and communist ideas and believed that a crucial role was being played by the British and other foreign activists being sent by the Comintern). **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
 - Through their activities, they filled the political vacuum at a time when the national movement was recouping its strength.
 - They exposed the hollowness of the Montford scheme.
 - They demonstrated that the councils could be used creatively.
 - **NOTE:** In the November 1923 elections, the **Swarajists had managed to win 42 out of 141 elected seats and a clear majority in the provincial assembly of Central Provinces.** In legislatures, in cooperation with the Liberals and the independents like Jinnah and Malaviya, they won a majority. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**

Q 90.A

- **Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP):** The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) is a regional political party, as approved by the Election Commission of India.
 - It was **formed in March 1940 in Ramgarh**, mainly as a political manifestation of the Anushilan Samiti or the Liberation Movement in Bengal. It also draws its roots from the Hindustan Socialist Republican Army.
 - Ideologically RSP was **closer to the Congress Socialist party than the Communist party. Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
 - In the Gandhi-Bose tussle, the R.S.P. **supported Subhash Chandra Bose.**
 - It **refused to support the allied war effort even after it was joined by U.S.S.R** had joined the allies. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Q 91.A

- **Lees-Mody Pact (October 1933)** by a **Bombay textiles group** agreed to further **preferences for British textiles in place of Japanese imports in return for a Lancaashire promise to buy more Indian raw cotton.** Sir Homi Mody was a noted Parsi businessman associated with Tata Group and an administrator of

India. Japanese textiles were increasing market shares in India dramatically. Thus, Duty on Japanese import increased from 31.5% to 75%.

- **Subhash Chandra Bose established the National Planning Committee in 1938** under the **chairmanship of Jawaharlal Nehru** with the **goal of setting up an economic plan** with the core goal of **ensuring a sufficient standard of living for the masses**. The formation of a fifteen-member National Planning Committee followed, with the Committee emphasising in a memorandum that national independence is an indispensable main condition for taking all steps that may be found necessary for carrying out the plan in all of its various elements. It was the **first attempt by the Indian people to evaluate the country's underlying economic problems and devise a coordinated plan** for the people's upliftment.
- **The 'Bombay Manifesto', signed in 1936** by twenty-one Bombay businessmen, contained an open indictment of Nehru's preaching of socialist ideals, which were deemed prejudicial to private property, and to the peace and prosperity of the country. Although it did not evoke support from any other section of the business community, it strengthened the hands of the moderates within the Congress, like Bhulabhai Desai and G.B. Pant, who put pressure on Nehru to tone down his socialist utterances.
- **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 92.C

- **One Nation-One Fertilizer (ONOF):** The concept of One Nation-One Fertilizer (ONOF) has been implemented from October 2, 2022.
 - As **part of the initiative, crop nutrients -- urea, di-ammonium phosphate (DAP), or muriate of potash (MOP) will be sold under a single brand name, 'Bharat' irrespective of the manufacturing companies. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - All fertilizer bags, whether containing urea or di-ammonium phosphate (DAP) or muriate of potash (MOP) or NPK will sport the brand name 'Bharat Urea', 'Bharat DAP', 'Bharat MOP', and 'Bharat NPK' irrespective of the company that manufactures (private or public).
 - The concept is **brought under the Centre's fertilizer subsidy scheme, Pradhanmantri Bhartiya Janurvarak Pariyojana (PM-BJP). Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - The new brand name and logo with subsidy title, Pradhanmantri Bhartiya Janurvarak Pariyojana, will occupy two-thirds of the printable area on the bag and one-third will be used for putting details of the fertilizer companies and its symbol with other information as per the rules.
- **Benefits:**
 - A single brand name will help in the reduction of freight charges due to stopping of crisscross movement of fertilizers, reducing the transit time, and ensuring the availability of fertilizers throughout the year irrespective of brand preferences.
 - It will also stop the diversion of urea for industrial purposes.
 - The Government gives a huge subsidy on these products which is more than the maximum retail price, therefore, subsidy schemes will also be mentioned on the bag.

Q 93.D

- The last phase of Tilak's career, 1914-20, was marked by his sponsorship of the Indian Home Rule League. It may be noted that until the Lucknow session of the Indian National Congress in December 1916 Tilak was not readmitted to its sessions and committees meetings.
 - **The branches of the All India Home Rule League of Annie Besant were afforded the opportunity of propagating the message of the Self-Government resolution of Congress. But even at the Lucknow session of the Congress, Tilak's Indian Home Rule League and its branches were not afforded this opportunity. Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- Tilak established the Indian Home Rule League on 28 April 1916 at Belgaum, while Annie Besant commenced propaganda of her Home Rule League earlier in January 1916.
- **The President of Tilak's Home Rule League was Joseph Baptista of Bombay and Secretaries N.C. Kelkar and Gokhale. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- Within a year since its establishment, the membership of Tilak's League registered strength of thirteen to fourteen thousand; in 1918 it reached thirty-four thousand. The League's membership was drawn from people of different religions, including Muslims and Christians, of different castes among Hindus, upper,

middle, and lower, and also from women. Annie Besant's League's appeal was mainly directed at the English educated.

- **The deputations of both Tilak's and Besant's Leagues went to Britain independently of that of the Congress to plead for the early grant of responsible government before the Joint Parliamentary Committee. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The Home Rule League movement not only afforded Tilak and his followers an independent platform apart from Congress, but it also consolidated his own following, and most importantly, exerted pressure on Congress to own the demand for home rule and transmit it to the British government both here and in Britain.

Q 94.B

- By 1929, the Government was deeply worried about the rapidly growing communist influence in the national and trade union movements. **It arrested thirty-two radical political and trade union activists, including three British Communists** — Philip Spratt, Ben Bradley and Lester Hutchinson — who had come to India to help organize the trade union movement.
 - **Thus was launched the famous Meerut Conspiracy Case**, the most important link in a chain of repressive measures : the Public Safety Bill and Trade Disputes Bill, the prosecution of and death sentences to Bhagat Singh and his comrades and so on.
 - **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- The defence of the prisoners was to be taken up by many nationalists including Jawaharlal Nehru, M.A. Ansari and M.C. Chagla. Gandhiji visited the Meerut prisoners in jail to show his solidarity with them and to seek their cooperation in the coming struggle.
- Some of the prominent leaders who were tried in this case were
 - **Muzaffar Ahmad**
 - He edited daily Nabajug in 1920 with Qazi Nazrul Islam. Along with friend and comrade Abdul Halim, initiated communist work inside the national movement.
 - He was a member of the Bengal Provincial Congress Committee and member of the All India Congress Committee.
 - **He was Sentenced to four years rigorous imprisonment in Kanpur Conspiracy Case in 1924.**
 - **Shripad Amrit Dange**
 - **Shripad Amrit Dange was a founding member of the Communist Party of India (CPI)** and a leader in the Indian trade union movement. During the British Raj, he was arrested by the British authorities for communist and trade union activities and was jailed for a total of 16 years.
 - **Puran Chand Joshi**
 - **He worked in the Workers and Peasants Party of Uttar Pradesh, formed at Meerut in October 1928 with himself as the General Secretary.**
 - **Shaukat Usmani, Sohan Singh Josh, Kedar Nath Sehgal, Gobinda Ramchandra Kasse, Radha Raman Mitra. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The three-and-a-half-year trial resulted in the conviction of Muzaffar Ahmed, S.A. Dange, Joglekar, Philip Spratt, Ben Bradley, Shaukat Usmani, and others. The trial got worldwide publicity but weakened the working class movement.

Q 95.D

- The nationalist movement acquired a subaltern character with the beginning of the Tuticorin Coral Mills strike. It provides important insights into the class character of the nationalist movement in Tamil Nadu.
- **Working conditions in these mills were extremely poor. In 1908, a total of 1695 workers, 59 percent of them aged 14—16, worked at Coral Mills owned by the British. Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- **On 27 February 1908, the Coral Mills workforce decided to go on strike; their demands included a reduction in the number of working hours and a pay increase. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **The workers' cause was taken up by V.O. Chidambaram Pillai, who had long been interested in labor welfare, and the striking workers quickly gained the sympathy and support of the people of Tuticorin. Hence statement 2 is correct.**

- Even prior to Gandhiji's Champaran Satyagraha, V.O. Chidambaram Pillai took up the cause of the working class in Tamil Nadu, and thus he is a forerunner to Gandhiji in this respect.
- The formal birth of the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company (SSNCo), on October 16, 1906, was largely the personal achievement of V.O. Chidambaram Pillai.

Q 96.A

- Recent Context: The Earth had its shortest-ever day on June 29, 2022, due to a wobble in its axis which meant it completed a single spin in a fraction of a second less than 24 hours. The Chandler wobble or Chandler variation of latitude is a small deviation in the Earth's axis of rotation relative to the solid earth, which was discovered by and named after American astronomer Seth Carlo Chandler in 1891.
 - Earth completed its spin in 1.59 milliseconds less than 24 hours on June 29 this year.
 - While scientists are yet to conclude the reasons behind the downtrend in Earth's rotational speed, it is being attributed to Chandler wobble.
- **Chandler wobble is the change in the spin of Earth on its axis. Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- The wobble was first spotted in the late 1880s when astronomer Seth Carlo Chandler noticed the poles wobbled over a period of 14 months.

Q 97.B

- **On 1st October 1906, thirty-five Muslim leaders from all over India gathered in the viceregal Lodge at Shimla to present a memorandum to Lord Minto. They were led by Agha Khan, a former member of the Viceroy's Legislative Council. 'It was in this address that the claim to separate Muslim representation was made, and it was in the reply given by His Excellency that the claim is commonly understood to have been conceded. Hence statement 1 is not correct and statement 2 is correct.**
- They stated that Muslims are a distinct community with additional interests of their own, which are not shared by other communities, and no Muslim would ever be returned by the existing electoral bodies unless he worked, in sympathy with the Hindu majority in all matters of importance.
- On these grounds the deputation made the following proposals :
 - In the case of municipal and district boards, the number of Hindus and Muslims entitled to seats should be declared; such proportion being determined in accordance with the numerical strength, social status, local influence, and special requirements of either community and that each community should be their own representative, as in the Aligarh Municipality and in many towns in Punjab.
 - In the case of provincial Legislative Councils, the proportion of Muslim representatives should be determined and declared with due regard to the considerations noted above, and that the important Muslim landlords, lawyers, merchants, and representatives of other important interests, the Muslim members of district boards and municipalities and Muslim graduates of universities of a certain standing, say five years, should be formed into electoral colleges and be authorized to return the number of members that may be declared to be eligible.
 - **For their representation in the Imperial Legislative Council, they suggested:-**
 - **That the proportion of Muslims should not be determined on the basis of numerical strength and that they should never be an ineffective minority.**
 - **Thus the memorial pointed out, "the position accorded to the Muslim Community in any kind of representation, direct or indirect, and in all other ways affecting their status and influence should be commensurate not merely with their numerical strength, but also with their political importance and the value of the contribution which they make to the defense of the Empire. Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
 - That as far as possible appointment by-election should be given preference over the nomination.
 - For the purpose of choosing Muslim members, Muslim landowners, lawyers and merchants, and representatives of every important interest of status to be subsequently determined by the government, Muslim members of provincial legislative councils and Muslim fellows of universities should be invested with electoral powers.

Q 98.D

- The Royal Indian Navy Mutiny also called the **1946 Naval Uprising**, started as a strike by ratings (a designation for a sailor subordinate to officers) on 18 February 1946 **demanding better food and accommodation**.
- The Indian sailors were treated badly by their British commanders and there were stark **differences in the pay, living conditions, and basic amenities of Indians and British sailors in the navy**. The strike **started in Bombay harbour** where a contingent of ratings had arrived. The **ratings of HMIS Talwar**, a shore establishment also had seething discontent against their seniors for similar reasons. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The strikers were inspired by the INA trials and the persona of Subhas Chandra Bose. Soon, the strike evolved into open revolt with many cities joining the Bombay sailors, Sailors from Karachi, Calcutta, Poona, Vizag, Cochin, Madras, Mandapam and the Andaman Islands joined involving 66 ships and shore establishments.
- The open revolt **struck at the heart of the British establishment** who now realised that **the armed forces**, which was one of their key tools in maintaining their mastery over the subcontinent, **could no longer be relied upon. Congress did not officially support these upsurges because of their tactics and timing**. Negotiations had been an integral part of the Congress strategy, to be explored before a mass movement could be launched, especially when the British were seen to be preparing to leave soon. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- In Gandhi's opinion, the mutiny was badly advised: if they mutinied for India's freedom, they were doubly wrong; if they had any grievances, they should have waited for the guidance of leaders. **The mutiny came to an end with the intervention of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**. The mutineers surrendered on 23 February 1946.

Q 99.A

- **Government of India Act, 1919:** The franchise was extremely restricted.
 - Only those paying an income tax on the minimum income of Rs.10,000 a year or those paying a minimum land revenue of Rs. 750 a year were entitled to vote, In addition, the other qualifications were that either a person must be on the Senate of a university or he must have some past experience in some Legislative Council of India, or he must be title-holder.
 - Out of the entire population in India in 1920 of 24 crores not more than 17,364 persons possessed the requisite qualifications for a vote.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 100.A

- **Among the several 'actions' of the reorganized groups was the attempt to assassinate Charles Tegart, the hated Police Commissioner of Calcutta, by Gopinath Saha in January 1924.** By an error, another Englishman named Day was killed. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- The Government came down on the people with a heavy hand. A large number of people, suspected of being terrorists, or their supporters, were arrested under a newly promulgated ordinance. These included Subhash Chandra Bose and many other Congressmen. **Saha was hanged despite massive popular protest. The revolutionary activity suffered a severe setback. Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
- The Gopinath Saha Case almost resulted in a second split in the Indian National Congress. The principle of non-violence was clearly violated when the Bengal unit of the Congress, prompted by Chittaranjan Das, praised what it called Saha's self-sacrifice, setting, as it were, the cat among the pigeons.
- **A resolution was moved at the All India Congress Committee at Gandhi's instance in June 1924, which characterized Saha's action as misguided love of the country and disapproved emphatically of all political murders as inconsistent with the Congress creed. This resolution could be passed by 78 in favour and 70 against. Though Gandhi won, he considered the passing of the resolution by a razor thin margin as his defeat. Hence statement 2 is correct.**